Book Title (year of reading)	Author	Learnings / my notes	Comment	Status (reading, finished, gave up, planning)	Would I recommend it? (* = bad, don`t recommend ** = readable, don`t recommend *** = interesting / good, **** = must read / great ***** = epiphany / masterpiece)
2025					
Siblings Without Rivalry: How to Help Your Children Live Together So You Can Live Too	Adele Faber, Elaine Mazlish	1. Don't compare siblings. 2. Don't treat them equally — treat them individually. 3. Acknowledge feelings before solving anything. 4. Describe problems without taking sides. 5. Coach instead of refereeing. 6. Stop labeling children ("the smart one," "the calm one"). 7. Encourage cooperation, not competition. 8. Jealousy is normal—address it with empathy, not logic. 9. Intervene only as much as necessary. 10. Teach repair, not guil	Really good.	finished	***
A New Earth: Awakening Your Life's Purpose	Eckhart Tolle	1.Most suffering comes from identifying with your thoughts. 2.The "ego" is the false identity built from roles and past pain. 3.The "pain-body" is old emotion that activates under stress. 4.Presence dissolves ego reaction. 5.Watch thoughts instead of believing them. 6.Don't identify with roles ("parent," "leader," "achiever"). 7.Speak and act from awareness, not from your triggered state. 8.Accept the present moment as it is — no resistance. 9.Conscious relationships require responsibility for your emotions. 10.A "new earth" emerges when many individuals shift from ego to awareness.	A little repetitive after the Power of Now, or for one with some backgorund with mindfullness.	finished	***
The Power of Now: A Guide to Spiritual Enlightenment	Eckhart Tolle	1. Most suffering comes from past and future thinking. We react emotionally to memories and imagined scenarios instead of what is actually happening now. 2. The present moment is the only real place life happens. When you bring awareness into the Now, stress and mental noise naturally reduce. 3. You are not your thoughts — you can observe them. Watching the mind creates space, and that space gives you choice instead of automatic reaction. 4. The pain-body is old emotional baggage that activates under stress. If you notice the activation early, you prevent it from taking over your behaviour. 5. Acceptance of the present stops internal resistance. You can still act to improve situations, but without the tension created by "this shouldn't be happening." 6. Use clock time for practical tasks, not for emotional rumination. Planning is useful; replaying past hurts or worrying about the future only creates suffering. 7. Shift attention to your inner body to return to presence quickly. Feeling your breath, hands, or feet interrupts overthinking within seconds. 8. In relationships, presence breaks the trigger–reaction cycle. When you stay aware instead of defensive, arguments de-escalate and connection strengthens. 9. The ego is a mental identity built from roles, opinions, and stories. When you stop identifying with it, criticism and setbacks stop feeling like threats. 10. Awareness itself is the path to freedom. The moment you notice a thought or emotion consciously, you are no longer controlled by it.	I have not had a book that had such a profound intellectual effect on my that felt comparable to the peace of a 10 day silent retreat, and it reaches by purely logical tools. Fantastic. Heals depression.	finished	*****
Secrets of Sand Hill Road: Venture Capital and How to Get It	Scott Kupor, Eric Ries				
The Anxious Generation: How the Great Rewiring of Childhood Is Causing an Epidemic of Mental Illness	Jonathan Haidt				
How to Talk So Little Kids Will Listen: A Survival Guide to Life with Children Ages 2-7	Joanna Faber, Julie King	Acknowledge feelings and with words and emphatize before correcting. Write it down to acknowledge. Express feelings with art, draw Give in fantasy what you cannot give real, Keep it playful Name the isse, not the the behaviour Resist to ask a distressed child Give desciptive praises not generic ones Avoid labels or roles, but point out situations when they behave differently to broaden the self image Give choices, engage in coopertion rahter than command Describe the issue but don't criticize Visual routines with clocks, charts than nagging Brainstorm about the solutions together			
Fierce Intimacy	Terrence Real	Recognize and manage your adaptive child, address self sabotaging behaviours that served well as a child, transition from reactive patterns, to thoughful responses as a functional adult. Relationship grid: are you more the one up (grandiosity) or one down type (shame)? Are you more boundaryless or walled off? Identify yourself, your partner, and try to manage accordingly. Try to pull towards the middle. Avoid the 5 loosing strategies: being right, controlling your partner, enbridled self expression, retaiation, withdrawal. Implement 5 winning strategies: shifting from complaint to request, listening with compassion, empowering each other, cherishing one other. Core Negative Image: the purple image how your partner sees you at your worse, it is not you, not even true at your worse but nevertheless it is true. Relational mindfulness: develop awareness. Engage in repair process. Repair is more important than harmony. Relationship is harmony, disharmony and repair. Withdrawal is only acceptable if it has a time limit and it serves the repair process. If you talk about the relationship to address issues then stay with the role. There is needs to be one who talks and the other one who listens. The answer cannot be a "but you" and then talk about my own problems. Listen and try to emphasize. If you are talking about the problems never use the pronouns you or even it. Talk about the complaint with the 5 step approach, and max 2 sentences each: 1, what happened, 2, how you feel about about it (really feelings like anger etc.), 3, how you think about it ("I made it up"), 3 what can you do about it. You cannot expect something if you do not say it. There are 3 modes of negotiation: invite, request, demand. Invite is the best "Do you want?". "Would you?" is already putting pressure. Nobody likes to be controlled or forced. If the partner neglects, deal with it. Be vulnerable.	Very practical, no nonsense approach to realtionships.	finished	****
Jhāna Consciousness: Buddhist Meditation in the Age of Neuroscience	Paul Dennison				
Good Inside: A Guide to Becoming the Parent You Want to Be	Becky Kennedy				

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Getting the Love You Want: A Guide for Couples: Third Edition	Harville Hendrix, Helen LaKelly Hunt				
2024					
Nexus: A Brief History of Information Networks from the Stone Age to AI					
The Singularity Is Nearer: When We Merge with AI	Ray Kurzweil				
The Power Law: Venture Capital and the Making of the New Future	Sebastian Mallaby				
The Awakened Family: A Revolution in Parenting	Shefali Tsabary Ph.D.	Parents and children primarely have a time zone issue. Pranents live in the futre, they want to get things done to achieve the next thing, whereas kids just want to focus on the moment. Parents need to recognize that we should not try to fix children, and parents need to grow more than the kids. Our conflcit with kids surfaces exactly the challanges we had with our ownparent too.			
Outlive: The Science and Art of Longevity	Peter Attia MD	Medicine 1.0 is based on observations and beliefs. Medicine 2.0 is evidence based but was developed to treat serious issues, not to prevent. Medicine 3.0 is a preventive, personalized, digital health enabled approach. Rapamicin was found at Easter Islands in a soil sample. Immunosupressant in one reginem, but can also be immune system enhancing if cycled properly. The first ever drug in mammels that could increase life span, by around 10%. It targets MTOR, wich is a like a general contractor for repair mechanisms and pathways. Centenarians, who are over 100 years old typically age slower, even at their 60ties their markets are 10-20 years behind, often even if they do not live a healthy life. However, only 3 genes were found until now that can play a role. Very likely all other factors are combined small effects. Two from the 3 genes are cholesterin or metabolism related. Assessing cardio / atherosclerosis risk: APOB more predictive than LDL, CT angiogram is very helpful, LBa is an other potential important factor.			
2023					
Trillion Dollar Coach: The Leadership Playbook of Silicon Valley's Bill Campbell	Eric Schmidt, Jonathan Rosenberg, Alan Eagle	Copy notes.		Finished	
The Hard Thing About Hard Things: Building a Business When There Are No Easy Answers	Ben Horowitz			Reading	
Elon Musk: Tesla, SpaceX, and the Quest for a Fantastic Future	Ashlee Vance	Was an awkward antisocial geek, not outstanding student but had a die hard work ethic to everything he was interested in. Parents were very adventurous, moving continents, having their on private crappy jet to travel the world. He personally hunted down the best of the best of students, experts etc. mostly young people without families who are willing to work like tree other people but with average salaries. Musk has an excellent memory and never tired to learn, he rarely writes things down. He is always fast with everything, even with peeing. He sets epic schedules and expects hourly schedules in plans for projects. Musk does not say I want you to do this by Friday… He says I need the impossible by Friday, can you do it? He makes huge decisions alone and fast, and can turn the Organisation around in minutes. They can change SW code while Falcon is on the launchpad already 10 mins before launch. But he also knows Engineering and physics as nobody else, and expects everyone to root decisions in basic principles e.g physics. Tesla has not only created the first working electric car but the model S around 2012 was selected as the best car of the year in front of all other types. It has been full of issues and recalls but Musk used these as opportunities to delight with customer service: fixing the car remotely overnight by software updates, or picking up your car and giving a replacement when recalls were needed. The last American carmaker to reach mass production with million scale was Chrysler that was founded in 1925. Musk is the ultimate long term thinker. Musk does not party much but loves Burning Man, it is his yearly camping where he dances a lot and emerges in self expression. Musk companies including SpaceX, Tesla and side projects like Solarcity were not really built on a business model but rather based on a world view, and organized to attract the best talent of the industry around that mission to work harder than anybody else. Musk can be incredibly inemphatetic and uses people for this mission like a bullets that burn out. There are not many people who liked to work for him, and he dumps even his closest and most loyal people instantly when he does not see the relationship working anymore. However, most of those people still adore him for what he is accomplishing.	One of the best biographies I have ever read, more analytical than chronical, super inspiring.	Finished	****

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The Permanent Portfolio: Harry Browne's Long-Term Investment Strategy	Craig Rowland	Rules Of Harry Browne for investing: 1, accept that your career will bring the majority of your money throughout your life if you take appropriate risk in investing. 2, the money you invest is the time you worked, you will never be able to recover those losses of bad investment 3, speculation in not investment 4, nobody can predict the future 5, market timing is impossible 6, no trading system works as good as in the past 7, no leverage 8, no third party should manage your money 9, dont invest in anything you don't understand 10, don't depend on any one institution, person, etc 11, bulletproof portfolio, that works in every economic environment 12, speculate with money separately you can loose, and keep it in a separate part 13, keep money outside of the country 14, use legal tax avoidant schemes 15, use budget for pleasure, you are not sure how long you live 16, if you are unsure about an investment then rather stay on the sidelines Stock, Gold, bond bugs tend to forget that any of these asset classes were negative multiple times a decade or more the 20th Century which is an unrecoverable loss within anyone's working years if you are unlucky. A portfolio diversification usually fails for typical reasons: too much of one asset class, assets exposed to the same risks, false assumptions based on asset class correlations in the past, holds no cash or hard assets. John Norsted - The fallacy of time diversification: stocks do not become less risky if you own them for long term. They can get cut half at the 20th year and the overall return can be very poor. Inverse correlation e.g. US stocks and long term bonds can correlate positively or negatively based on the period, and viewing a single decade in the 20th century a completely wrong conclusion can be made. 4 basic configs on an economy: prosperity, deflation, recession, inflation. Prosperity: rising productivity, low unemployment and interest rates, wide optimism, stock perform well. Good for bonds and stocks. Deflation: economics shock starts a cycle of declining prices, falling interest rates, loans dry up, ppl reduce spending, inventories cannot be sold on profit. Good for bonds and cash. Recession: any economic condition outside prosperity, but mostly here refer to a tight money recession when central bank raises interest rates in an already weak economy, this is a temporary period 12-24 months till consumers start spending again, till the economy adjusts to a lower level of demand. Good for cash. Inflation: results of too much money available compared of goods, also accompanied by rising interest rates, this is a response of the bond holders wanting more. It results in wage price spiral and often a sustained period of high inflation. Good for gold - which is not a good investment but a good insurance policy. The permanent portfolio only employed 25+ years maturity treasury bonds, ideally directly or through a passive fund. TIPS don't work under deflationary environments. Municipal and mortgage back bonds have call risks. International bonds have international currency and default risk. Etc. Gold should be viewed as an insurance policy. More direct ownership is preferred. There are direct ownership metal accounts, better than ETFs. Standardized coin formats also preferred that every dealer accepts, but bullion bars are too big and not as recognizable as coins. Other commodities cannot be owned directly and used as money in a crisis so they do not offer this type of protection thus not suitable for the permanent portfolio. The same applies for mining stocks, or collectibles. Silver is a good diversified but it is also more an industrial material. TIPS have a conflict of interest problem: the govt creats inflation and also can manipulate CPI indexes. International investors should own regional stock indexes, regional currency, regional government bonds. If 25y+ long term bonds are not available for the region than increase the bond percentage. Buying standard gold bullions is preferable like Austrian Mint - Vienna Philharmonic Bullion. Storing gold at an non allocated, allocated, or segregated form is giving increasing protection. Islands with natural resources and stable systems like New Zealand or Australia are best. Fees are high though, 1%-2% per transaction and per year. Check Globalhold in Switzerland and Everbank in US. Safe deposit box anonymously e.g. in Austria Dassafae.	Really good introductory lesson about portolfio theory in practise, and an incredibly simple but effective way to implement it.	Finished	****
The Montessori Toddler	Simone Davies	Don't test the kids all the time unless you know that he can answer, cos that's discouraging. Don't draw on the same paper, as side to side comparison is discouraging. Don't tell too often if a drowning is nice or not, let them develop their own judgement. Follow the child, encourage hands on learning, encourage creativity, involve in daily activities, create a safe base and environment, allow time, observe. Cultivate internal motivation instead of external praises, as kids can turn into praise junkies instead of developing their internal judgment. Avoid threats, bribes and punishment. Say no only when in danger and use rather words like later, only if, that is not the time for it etc.	Tons of good anecdotal examples with a rather simple theory around.	Finished	***
2022					

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Lifespan: Why We Age—and Why We Don't Have To	David A. Sinclair	Free radicals neutralizing antioxidants help but did not prove to extend lifespan significantly. Aging is not coused by accumulating DNA damage and mutations, even clones did no live shorter life. The new theory the past 10 yeras, is that there is no single reason but halmarks of aging: genetic instability, atrition of the chromosomal end caps the telomers, alteration of the epigenome, lost of protein regulation (proteostasis), deregulated nutrient-sensing, mitochondrial disfunction, accumulation of zombie like senesent cells, stem cell exhaustion, and altered intercellular communication. Aging is information loss. Digitial / genetic information is not lost, but analogue / epigeneitc information can carry more information but gets lost in translation. Organisms are either hungry and grow, or horny and breed. Epigenetic regulators like Sirtuin eg SRI2 genes are responsible for the switch and at the same time for dna / epigenetic repair too, so as long as they work on repair with time they start malfunctioning. Calorie restricted diet without malnutrition is one of the most powerful mechanisms to turn on survival mechanisms. Either periodic or general calory restrictiin works. Low animal protein diet is also an important trigger. Physical activity, in any amount but especially HIIT when you reach over 80% max heart beat. Cold exposure, also heat exposure. Four most important compounds for logevity as of today. Rapamicin, wich was discoverd as an antifughal, has immunsupressant effect, but it is toxic long term so "repalogs" or similars witouth the toxic effect are being researched now. Metfromin is an insulin sensitiviser, it creates metabolic slowdown. Reservatol is in red wine and it also helps but only in much larger qunatitites.NMN is the newest. Scenesent cells are zombie cells, likely a mechanism developed to stop cancer cells, but they are spreading through inflammatory signals. Scenilitics are compounds that might kill them or vaccines like PDL1 is also possible. Yamanaca factors: transcription factors that can turn back time, and turn any cells to stem cells. We can do that to some level even today, but with the current tech this often turns cells tumor cells. Pharmaceutical products are male biased because of how clinical trials are designed. NIH funding per therapeutic area… aging gets little, even that goes mostky for alzheimer. Current healthcare suffers from agism, it does not want fix much after 50 only to keep people less sick. The evidence that GMO plants are safe are as strong as the evidence for climate change. What David Synclair does: 1000mg NMA, 1000mg resverstol in a yoghurt, 1000mg metformin, vitamin D K2, 83mg aspririn, sugar / bread / pasta as low as possible, no dessert, skip a meal a day, every few months blood test, most weekend gym sauna and ice bath, minimal meat especially mammals only after training, minimal UV CT, no microwaved plastic, cool temperature at home, optimal bmi 23-25. Supplements only gmp from large companies, highly purified. NMN (NAD booster)	Very insigthful, sometimes overly optimistic and senstionalist, but start of a hugely important journey as I turned 40.	Finishd	*****
A Random Walk Down Wall Street	Burton Malkiel	Invesment theories of the past: efficent market, greater fool, castle in the sky, boom and bust, but Isaac Newton "I can calucalte the motion of the heavenly bodies in the air but not the madness of the people" who lost a lot on the South Sea Company British joint-stock bubble. Conglomerate con scheme: companies merged justify higher PEs then the originals, eg staple merging to tech, but this is just alchemy. 60ties Concept stocks: selling an image, than a business. 70ties Nifty 50: IBM, Xerox, etc Buy once, and don´t worry about the price, becouse they will always grow. Then collapsed... 90-80ties: sell everything with biotech, robots, tech, etc. in the business. America produced the largest booms and busts of the 20st century but by not far. E.g. the Japan real estate prices increased 70x between 1950 and 1990ties, and worth 5x more than all US land while US 25x bigger. Japan land was about 20% of all worlds wealth. Then collapsed and could not even climb back to the levels for the past 20+ years. 2000 dotcom, bitcoin etc show that the greatest tech breakthroughs create the largest bubbles. Weak efficient market hypothesis = tech, fundamental etc analysis would not gain sufficient over performance that would justify it over buy and hold. Modern portfolio theory: a portfolio diversification eliminates unsystematic risk, but the remaining systematic risk is still there. Risk premium in an asset is only paid for for systematic risk risk that cannot be diversified away - this is the capital asset pricing model theory which earned Sharp a Nobel price. Eugene Fama and Kenneth French analyzed 30 years of data and concluded that there was no correlation between beta and return. This recognition was called the death of beta and the capital asset pricing model in the 90ties. Part of the problem is that it is difficult to define and measure beta as all different aspects of risk. It still holds true that higher returns require higher risks. Behavioral science showed that heard behavior makes investors invest the wrong time in the wrong assets especially at the extremes. For most investors it is more important to avoid these basic mistakes then actually to thrive for outperformance. Smart beta strategies tilt portfolios towards value, size, momentum and low beta which resulted in good risk adjusted returns historically. There are now 0,5 trillion worth of smart beta assets but in practice it is almost impossible to replicate the results either with single of multiple factor probably as the premiums got arbitraged away after they get published. Equal weighted portfolios are a kind of smart beta fund but they are not tax efficient. Ray Dalio developed risk parity portfolios, where different components of the portfolio contribute equally to overall portfolio risk, then different tricks can be applied e.g. low beta portfolios leveraged. Investing is about to find a good balance between being able to eat well and sleep well. The stock exchange is like a casino where we he odds are tilted in your favor if you if you avoid basic mistakes. Long term expected return = yield + growth + multiple change. Multiple changes throughout shorter cycles, go up at extreme optimism, down in extreme pessimism. 5 rules to select stocks if you really want to do it (which is completely irrational, index the core and take only few bets for fun): companies should have 5 years above average earnings growth, GARP - growth at a reasonable price: not much above market average by PE; psychological story and contagious elements e.g. followers who build castles in the air; trade as little as possible and only sell loosers for tax loss harvesting.	Best and most up to date investement book. There was not much new for me but the book covers everything I learned in 10 years about invesmtent, this should had been my first book. It is biased towards indexing though.	Finihsed	****
No Bad Kids: Toddler Discipline Without Shame	Janet Julian	Deal with your toddler like a CEO deals with a respected employee, with respect, understanding but firm leadership. Respectful parenting means giving space but clear boundaries too that are not negotiable. Set the limits early and clearly, recognizing our own limits without shame, and don´t let the toddler cross those. Acknowledge the toddlers feelings and his difficulty to stay within those limits. Consistent, predictable and calm response, not punishment. Don't let the kid push your buttons, don't react strongly or emotionally, as this will start the cycle. Tell that you recognize and accept the strong feelings, but will not allow the behaviors.	My first book on toddlers, I learned a lot. Very anecdotal but practical and dense.	Finished	****

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The Little Book That Beats The Market	**Joel Greenblatt**	Get stocks with market cpaitalization over X (the book does not have a clear recommendation but talks often about companies as small as 50M USD, and indicates the smaller the better). Rank them by earnings yield and return on capital, do simple equal weighted rank fusion, buy from top 30-50 a few every month with dollar cost averaging through a rolling window, hold them a year, sell, repeat. The formula is very simple and has close results of very complex and proven 70+ factors ranking systems. The system was tested in and out with good data science practises, roll forward, no survivorship bias, etc and seems to be extremely robust. It might underperform for a max of 1-3 years, but it beats the market long term almost surely. The two factors are really descibing the two most imprant value factors of a company, how profitable it is and how much you pay for future profits. The formula does not really factor in future prospects.	Very short, well written, and well tested. Although the whole strategy is about finding value traps and hoping that they are not.	Finished	***
Hold Me Tight	Sue Johnson			Reading	
Mastering the Market Cycles	Howard S. Marks	It is impossible to know where we are in the market cycle, but the intrinsic value gives some guidance on the odds. George Soros coined the terms boom and bust, the over optimisim and over pessimism cycles that usually follow each other. Oaktree started raising cash 2 years before the 2008 crash and started heavily buying from 2008 autumn when there was a clear over pessimism. However, there was no way to know if the crash will result in a 1930ties type of 10 year long recession or rapid rebound. Within 2 years most of the portfolios rebounded but this was only one of the possible futures that could have materialized. These often teach investors a wrong lesson becouse they expect the same, and this expecation increases the amplitude of a next boom or bust. You do not need to catch the bottom just making sure to have enough funds to keep investing while the market goes down, reached bottom and starts to up. A useful way to think about cycles is short and long term cycles that fluctuate around the long term trend line which seems to be stable even through industrial revolutions, wars etc. Long term cycles play out during several decades like demographics, globalization, etc. Short term cycles are influenced by forces like wars, weather etc. Central banks trying to control inflation and employment at the same time, and balance between the two. The governments use fiscal tools e.g. taxes and running in deficit or surplus to stimulate or weaken the economy. Both try to act in a counter cyclical way. Economyc cycle and stock prices move in large swings. The larger the swing into one direction, the larger the swing in the opposit direction too. Some business structures are basically leveraged e.g. operating on borrowed money, or large fixed cost items mean in good times profits increase fast as revenues increases, and in bad times profits and outlook fall much faster than the revenue. However, the swings are largely explained by psychology and are much more extreme than the business outlooks. Hence, the yearly return of the stock exchange is rarely around the long term yearly trend line: if the trend for the past ~50 years was ~10% the yearly return around that 10+-2% was less then one tenth of years, and fourth of the years it was under 10% or over 30%. Most of the times any economic development e.g. oil prices, infaltion, central bank measures can be interpreted in totally positive or negative ways. "Beinng emotional is good for marriage but not good for an investor. " Asset classes can be represented through a linear line at the return vs risk (horisontal) chart. The increase in expected return for riskier assets is the risk premium. During times of optimism when prices are already high, risk premium of riskier assets (e.g. from short threasury to long duration and corporate bonds towards larg cap stocks, to small cap stocks, real estate, and venture capital at the higest end) are lower than in pessimistic times. In pessimistic times the slope is steeper becouse fewer people want to buy risky assets, so the risk premium is higher. Wich means taking more risks results in higher expected retursn than in good times, wich makes riskier assets less risky in fact! Financial or credit cycle, risk and psychology cycle, economic cycle and also retail cycle are all chain reactions leading to booms and busts. The more extreme the up cycle to more extreme the down. All have short and long cycles and they effect each other. E.g. high liquidity and overly permissive loans leave less and less room for risk, but ppl are seemingly making more and more money, and banks need to serve the market so they give more and more loans. When an unexpected event collapses the market refinancing of loans become impossible and many gets bankrupt in a chain reaction. With real estate it is similar, when there is large demand and many new projects are built the effect only shows in a decade but then there are already too many projects in the making. Markets are not really efficient in this sense and fluctuates between overly positive or negative directions: because investors tend to follow the herd, discomfort in seeing others making money even if irrational, investment is about money and it introduces irrational elements like greed, and non-linear preferences over loosing and winning the same amount, etc. Bull or bear market trends in a cycle can be viewed in 3 stages: only a few believe that it can get better (worse), the majority sees the bull (bear) trend, and a clear sign of a bubble (panic and crash) when the valuation does not matter anymore (any risk is too much) as everyone believes the trend is only up (down). Being wrong is indistinguishable from being too far ahead of time. We are all wrong or early at significant amount of the time. Don't confuse brains with a bull market. Oak tree has been able to be consistently right about market positioning only about 4 times in 40 years at the most extremes. Only about once in 10 years, and even then multiple years too early in sometimes. Extremes in cycles can be recognized and utilized the best when many think there is no cyclicality or risk anymore. Timing cannot be done consistently, it is impossible to know where the cycle is going. However, valuations can be used to understand where we are right now in the cycle, and based on that adjust the aggressiveness or defensiveness of the portfolio, to higher or lower beta companies or asset classes, but more importantly buy stocks under their intrinsic value.	Super repetitive and very anecdotical but some good insights.	finished	***

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INSPIRED: How to Create Tech Products Customers Love	Marty Cagan	3 stages of a product: startup stage searching for a product/market fit, growth stage trying to scale, and enterprise stage to sustain product innovation. We know from A/B etc testing that half or two third of ideas, features etc will not bring any value. Prototypes or experiments need at last 10th of the work to test the hypothesis. Product Vision is for 2-10 years. PM has to be most most credible and talented in the organisation, that is can VCs also expecting, he needs a deep knowledge of the customer, data, business, market and industry. Product Designer and Product Marketing roles are other key roles fo the team besides of PM. Product Owner and Manager should not be split up. Key leadership level roles: head of product (product market fit), head of design (holistic user journey), head of technology. It is important have a good combination between CEO and head of product: one but only one of them as to be visionary and the other more operational. PMs can grow into principle PM as individual contributor, director/head of product as manager, or group product manager that is a compination of the two: a PM that has own team but a few more junior PMs report to him. Delivery manager can be also a key role to remove obstacles, he can be the same as the scrum master or project/program manager. Empowered product teams need to understand business context to be able to figure out solutions themselves. This has two main components: product vision and strategy, business objectives. This enables outcome based roadmaps and high integrity commitments. Product vision and strategy is like leadership and management, the first is inspirational, the second is focused on how to get there. Principles for product vision: start with why, fall in love with the problem not soltion, think big, don´t be afraid to disrupt yourselves becouse somebody else will, inspire, embrace meaningful trends, skate to where the puck is heading not to where it was, be stubborn on vision but flexible on the details, any product vision is a leap of faith, evengelize. Principles for product strategy: focus on one target market or persona at a time, it needs to be aligned with the business strategy, with sales and go-to-market strategy, obsess over customers not competitors, communicate strategy across the org. John Dorr OKRs are the best way to set and cascade objectives. Product evangelism is important: use prototype, share the pain with the team, share the vision, share learnings, give credit, learn to give great demos, do your homework on market, be excited and show enthusiasm, spend time with the team. Product discovery should eliminate main risks: value risk if it is valuable for the customer, usablity risk if the customer is able to figure it out, feasibility if we are abel to build it, and business risk if it works for our business: if it is financially viable, consistent with our brand, can our sales staff sell, legal and ethical risk. Opportunity assessment technique: use OKRs to evaluate. Customer letter: PM writes a press realease or cusotmer letter about an awesome product before even starting the work. User story mapping (activities, steps, details from left to write) and customer discovery pograms (picking about 6 reference customers, teaming up, and developing something for free, that works for all of them) Goog vs bad product teams: compelling product vision instead of mercenaries, inspriation by observing customers instead of collecting requiements, skills in rapidly trying out ideas instead of priotitzing lists and roadmaps, being happy about ideations instaed of offended by outsider telling what to do, product and engineering teams sitting together instead of in silos, running tests all the time instead of waiting for permissions, involving engineers in prototyping instead of telling them what to do, working with the customer constantly instead of keeping a distance, knowing that most ideas fail instead of being satisfied with delivery, right techniques to achieve speed in discovery instead of overwork, making high integrity commitments only if everything is in place instead of being pushed by sales to commit, real time metrics instead of nice to have analytics, continouous delivery and testing instead of batch releases, being obsessed with reference customers instead of competitors, celebrate business impact instead of release. What large companies miss when they loose innovation: cusomter-centric culture, compelling product vision, focused product strategy and product managers, stable teams, engineers part of discovery, corporate courage and willingness to disrupt, empowered product teams, product mindset that focuses on serving the customers and not primarely the business, time to pursue innovation instead of keep the lights on. Why do large companies loose velocity: technical dept, lack of strong product management or delivery management, lack product vision and strategy, lack of colocated abd durable product teams, engineers not part of discovery, not inculidng product design in discovery but only when engineers are building, changing priorities, too much of a consensus culture.	I am not sure how original is the book as I have read about most of the concepts... however, based on what I know I am assuming this was one of the first books to descibe every aspect of IT product management in a comrehensive and authentic way so it feels like a must read and staring point.	finished	****

Book Title (year of reading)	Author	Learnings / my notes	Comment	Status (reading, finished, gave up, planning)	Would I recommend it? (* = bad, don`t recommend ** = readable, don`t recommend *** = interesting / good, **** = must read / great ***** = epiphany / masterpiece)
Escaping The Build Trap	Melissa Perri	Bild trap is when and an org focuses on output of features, builds etc than outcomes. When the engineering team is so overwehalmed by delivering new builds that leaves no time for strategic thinking. Leadership is pushing for more things, features, apps, etc instead of thiking through value deeply. Value is when we solve problems for clients that they pay for, this is the value exchange system. Following competitors blindly to deliver, or not revisiting if shipped features brought value and not interating, are typical mistakes. Product are vehicles of value, they deliver value repeatedly without the need to build something new. Services primarely use human labour to deliver value. Most companies use a combination of products and services to deliver value. Sales-led, Visionary-led, Technology-led oragnisations are common and can be successfull for certain periods but they are not sustainable. Product-led organistaion is required for long term success. Product manager/owner needs to lead withouth authority, by an inspirational vision the team follows. Typical misinterprateations are the mini-CEO who wants power, the project manager type who focuses on calendars and output, and the Waiter who just collects the demand and puts it in a backlog. A PM does not need to be a market or tech expert altough benefitial, it is more important to be able to talk to both and know good product management principles. Scrum product owner = define backlog, prioritize, accept user stories. This is only a piece of product management. E.g. how to define and measure value etc. In SAFe a product manager is external facing, is a manager of product owners who are internal facing. User strories are cascaded down in a waterfall manner and get never validated. This is the weakest point of SAFe. Strategy is not a plan but a framework to make decisions. Two important components are development strategy to achieve the product vision, and the operational framework. The two should not be mixed. Creating a product vision with a only a few OKRs is key. A product usually emerges through experimentation while trying to acheive the product vision. Innovation can olny happen if leaders are making time and space for their teams to innovate by actively saying no certain things. Developing Product Katas: what is the goal? Are we now in relation to that goal? What is the biggest problem? How do we try to solve that? What did we learn so far? Experiment: Wizard of Oz (manual backend), concierge (follow each user) etc. Prioritizing work: north star document + story mapping, benefits mapping, Kano models, cost of delay, Core meetings to evaluate progress: quarterly business review, quarterly product initiative reviews: talk through experimentation etc, monthly release reviews: teams talk about achievements, roadmaps. Product roamaps meetings should cover the dollowing to now lock in what to deliver: theme, hypothesis, goals and success mettrics, stage of dev, milestones. Product operations team: automatied ways to collect data on goals and outcomes, report on goals, outcomes, roadmaps, progress, capacity, costs, organize product meetings, standardize procesess like roadmaps, feedback, docs, etc. Yearly budgeting cycles and commitments are the worst enemies of a product-led org. 6 questions to diagnose the maturity of the org: Who came up with the last feture idea? What is the last product you killed? When was the last time you talked to your customers? What is your goal? What are you currently working on? (talk about problems VS solutions) What are your roduct managers like? It is very important to be clear if we want to give a demo or a show a high-fidelity prototype to test assumptions. Demos or presentations are not suitable for discovery, testing value etc. Through prototypes there should be both quantitative (AB testing etc.) and qualitative ways (intererviews etc.) to test value. When testing for business viability it is important to identify all stakeholders who can put a release on hold. Everybody would have an optionon on the product in the company but only their opinion matters: sales, finance, legal, security, C-levels, etc.	A good collection of product management best practises but not too many original ideas.	finished	***
Team Topologies: Organizing Business and Technology Teams for Fast Flow	Manuel Pais and Matthew Skelton	Conway´s law (orgs which design systems are constrained to prduce designs which are copies of the comm structures of these orgs) VS reverse Conway´s manuver (loose couoling with cear boundaries). Engineering is a socio-technological system, teams and products map to each other so it is important to setup team in clear achitectural systems. Transform all teams into four funamental team types: stream aligned, platform, enabling, complicated-subsystem. Enabling team is composed of speciliast in a given domain and they help stream aligned teams to brindge capability caps. They are basically technical consultants. A complicated-subsystem team is responsible for building and maintainging a part of a system that depends heavily on specialist knowledge. A purpose of a platform team is to enable stream-aligned teams to deliver work with substantial autonomy, symplifying their work. So the platofrom provides internal services, assests etc with the Thinnest Viable Platform approach. Infra teams should be transformed into platform teams. DevOps teams should be a type of temporaraly enabling teams. Having a separate DevOps team is an antipattern. Architects should be in a part time enabling team. Tooling teams should be turned into a platform and enabling teams. Support should be the responsibility of 1, steam-aligned teams, or 2, if cross-team activity is needed to resolve then swarming of multiple teams. Monolithic applicaitons need to be broken down into steam aligned teams that minimizes the handoffs and maximize autonomy, altough the cut will create more inconsistencies. Cuts can be made in many different ways but requires substantial business knowledge. Working potential fracture panes can be: user personas, technology, performance isolation, risk, team location, change cadence, regulatory compliance domains, etc. Traditional IT Support is Tier based, DevOps prefers Swarm where everybody participates.	A very pragmatic model on how to think about engineering team topologies in standardized building blocks.	Finished	****

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The Most Important Thing	Howard Marks	Second level thinking: what do I know that others dont? What are the aspects that are not proiced in? Managing is risk is key, but risk is not volatilty. Volatility is the least important risk. Risk can be many types e.g. a portolfio not delivering during a given time frame, underperforming the benchmark etc. Risk is difficult to assess upfront, but also in hindsight, it is impossible to tell wich were the events that could have happened. Risk can be paradoxical becouse quality stocks can be overpriced and thus very risky, whereas lower qualty stocks where everyone perceives risks can be very cheap thus safe. This is a good domain to be contrarian. The market is like a pendulum from fear (risk awareness) to greed (risk chasing). Actually spends little time in the rational middle. However, it is impossible to predict how long the extremes will last or how extreme they will be. "Markets can stay irrational longer than you can stay solvent" Keynes ~1930 Market timing is only obvious at the extreme optimism or extreme pessimism wich happens about once a decade so it is difficult build a career around it. It is better to think about this like waiting for the market to offer good investments than looking for good investments. One should not confuse a great company with a great invesment. A great investment is one where price is lower than the value and the potential future return is greater than the risks. Most of this evaluation cannot be purely analytical and most of these investments actually have one visible defect otherwise the price would be too high. You simply cannot get great returns in a low return environment when prices are already too high. The dumbest thing is take more risk in these environments and try to perpetuate high returns. This results in huge losses. There are two types of analysyt: who do not know and the ones who do not know that they do not know. Forecasting is impossible with one excpetion: guessing the right market cycle can give a hint into the potential returns. Thus focus on the businesses. It is easier to have a better-than-average understanding of a business than having a better understanding of the macro environment. Understnading market cycles is the only meaningful way to gain insights into the future, and cycles need to be viewed with contrarian lenses. Hold on to your wallet IF - economy is vibrant (VS sluggish) - outlooks are positive (VS negative) - lenders are eager to give money (VS reticent) - capital markets are loose (VS tught) - capital is plentyful (VS scarce) - terms are easy (VS restrictive) - interest rates are low (VS high) - spreads are narrow (VS wide) - investors are optimistic (VS pessimistic) - asset owners are happy to hold (rushing to exits) - sellers are few (VS many) - markets are crowded (VS starved for attention) - hard to gain entry to funds (VS open to anyone) - recent performance is strong (VS weak) - asset prices are high (VS low) - prospecitve returns are low (VS high) - risk is high (VS low) -aggressive is the popular approach (VS defensive, selective, caution) The defensive investor does better in down markets, whereas the aggressive investor does better in upmarkets. The the approaches are incompatible. However, an important argument against the agressive apprach is that it can lead to unrecoverable losses wich are inevitable on long periods. There are not old aggressive investors. Buffett and others argue that the most imporant part of investing is to avoid unrecoverable mistakes.	A huge brain dump of commons sense insights on investing. This should be very usefull for new investors and a few interesting insights even more advanced. Very little supporting data or analytics but a credible author. However, I did not like that he is selling the "contrarian" value investing as a brilliant new idea called second level thinking.	finished	***
Principles for Navigating Big Debt Crises	Ray Dalio		Not an easy read.	reading	

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Common Stocks and Uncommon Profits and Other Writings	Philip Arthur Fisher	Scuttlebutt: 1, market potential, 2, management determination to reinvent (all current products are priced in), 3, RnD Effectiveness, 4, Sales org effectiveness, 5, Profit margin, 6, Improving profit margin, 7, personal relations to employees, 8, senior management with long tenures, 9, depth to management, managers working their way up from bottom, 10, accounting effectiveness, 11, how outstanding is it compared to competition, 12, short or long range look to profit, 13, does the company delute sharholder value to finance growth, 14, does the management transparently talking about failures, 15, managamanet integrity and ethics. Growth investing is a bet on long term compounding growth, value investing is buying a short term undervaluation e.g. by max 50%, rarely more. Economics forecasting is futile or very unrealiable. (- probably becouse it is a second level chatoic system which reacts to it´s own forecasting). It makes more sense to spend time on finding the right businesses for investing, or just use index funds (- and spend time on something more value adding like scince). Timing the market only makes sense in extreme situations, e.g. extreme overvaluation that always returns to the mean. Declines of 50% or more can happen in any company and market any time, so build positions gradually during longer periods in multiple years. Time to sell is almost never. Sell mostly only becouse of personal reasons when money is needed. Three exceptions: 1, a clear mistake was made when buyin, 2, change in management, 3, the original industry got exhausted. If you sell a company then you need to pay capital gain tax and can only reinvest after that. So you need to find a company that is much better then the previous one. The longer you hold, the larger the difference. Well growing companies almost always find better ways to reinvest their profit instead of paying dividends. Also, receiving dividend, paying taxes and reinvesting the leftover is very tax inefficient and slows compounding, such a strong headwind that is hard to beat. Don´ts Don´t buy promotional companies, meaning speculative businesses that do not make profit yet. These are only for specialized investors. Don´t ignore OTC stocks. Don´t assume high valuation already prices is growth and does not worth buying. Don´t overstress diversification. Min 10 with a variety of indiustries, but less then you can monitor. Don´t be afraid of buying during a war or fear of war, that is a buying opportunity and market always gets back. War is always infaltionary, so cash will worth less, and stock prices go up as their value expressed in money. The right approach is to keep buying slowly as nobody knows the bottom. Don´t put too much emphasis on past vlauations. Don´t wait for a good price. A precise price point does not matter for the long term investor. Don´t follow the larger crowd. Best track record often comes from copying great investors. (NOTES ARE MISSING AS THEY WERE on MY IPHONE THAT I MIGRATED AND AUDIBLE DID NOT SYNC, THANKS AUDIBLE!!) You need to recognize that it is simply impossible to achieve great returns in low return environments, when prices are high. It is dumb to try to take more risk and try to perpetuate high returns because these portolfios are hit harder when prices return to the mean. Never confuse good companies with good investments. Good investment is a low price compared to the value, and good prospects compared to the risks. Most part this evaluation cannot be fully analytical. Great companies are expensive. Ideally and counterintuitively there should be something wrong with the company that makes the price lower, but something that the market overreacts.	A great summary on conservative growth investing.	finished	****
Little Book of Common Sense Investing	John C. Bogle	Non-tax deferred active funds and portfolios are very tax inefficient becouse the realized gains are taxed and tax loss carry forward issues. Largest enemies of the investors: expenses, emotions, taxes. Exected returns are a sum of earnings growth, divident yield, and speculative change (P/E multiple change) From 2017 when the book was written the expected nominal stock returns are expected 2% divident + 4% earning growth - 2% PE contraction = 4%, Bonds rather 3%. Adjusted for 2% infaltion and 1% investment costs the expected return is 0 at best. Right now in 2022 after PE further expanded, this expected return is surely negative with index funds. There were all sorts of different active funds for tech, or focus fund to only invest in high conviction ideas, some of them do exceptionally in a given market environment but most of them get bankrupt after a few worse years as investors are puling out money. So actually it is really difficult to measure performance long term. Fund performance in one time period has almost zero predictive value for the next, performances will be almost renadomly distributed. Asset allocation e.g. stocks and bonds, more important than anything else e.g. sector, region, beta selection for performance. Graham at the late stage of his career admitted that the principles of Intelligent Investor do not work much anymore to find undervalued stocks and outperformed the market becouse the market efficiency and informaiton flow improved. Nevertheless the principles till work to make business and do not speculate.	This short book is very repetitive but brings a convinving amount of evidence that actually indexing is really the most rational approach by far. When Buffet and other great investors recomment, it sounds like indexing is for the crowds e. g. 9 out of 10 of retail investors, and there is a chance that you can be the one beating it. This book shows that it is actually even more powerfull and over 99%, even professionals, never beat it on longer periods of 10-20 years. Either 90, 99, or 99.9% the fact that it is safe, fool proof, and requires zero time investment makes me rethink my whole investment approach.	finished	****

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Intelligent Investor		"Investing is most intelligent when it is most business like." "Achieve satisfactory results is easier than most people realize, to achieve superior results is harder then it looks." "Don´t loose." Arithmetics: if a stock grows 10% a year on a market that grows 5% but your stock looses 50% at the forst year, it will take 16 years just to overtake the market. There is cose time connectionbetween inflationary or deflationary conditions and the movement of stock earnigs and prices. Gold might provide little to no inflationary protection for extended periods, e.g. the 35 years before 1972 when the book was written gold price went only up 35% even in absolut numbers not counting the storage costs. The other popolar protection is real estate but those are also subject to similarly wide fluctuations for extended periods. Being a defensive investor means following these rules: 1, no excessive or too little diversification with a minimum on 10 and a maximum of 30 issues. 2, each company should be large, prominent, and conservatively financed. 3, Each should have a long record of divident paymen e.g. 20 years. 4, Set a price limit, e.g. 20-25 PE where we take the average of the past ~7 years earnings. There are two ways to profit from market swings: focus on timing or price. If the investor places emphasis on timing and forecasting then ends up as a speculator with the financial results of a speculator. Focus on pricing means buying low and selling high compared to their fair value, or with a long term focus it is enough to just not pay too much for the stocks. Between 1897 and 1949 there were 10 complete market cycles from bottom to top to bottom. 6 of these were shorter than 4 years, 4 run for 6-7 years and one run 11 years between 1921-1932. From lows to high percentage were between 44-500%, declines from 24% to 89%. Nearly all bull markets had well defined characteristics: 1, historically high price level, 2, high PE, 3 low divident yields to bond yields, 4, lot of speculation on margin, 5, manny new offerings with poor quality. However, market did not behave that predictably during the 20 years leading to 1972 when the book was written, old danger signals stop working. This is partially becouse there are always new conditions on the market, and partially becouse the market itself reacts to trading theory. A conservative investor should follow a simpe strategy: buy only stocks with not much higher price than one third over their tangible asset value, and selecting reasonable PE sotcks with strong financial position. A speculator tries to profit from market fulctuations, where an investor is aquiring and holding securities at suitbale prices. An investor should buy stocks regualry whenever he has money except when general market level is much higher than can be justified by well established standards. The investor should always remember that market quotations are for convencience, either to be taken advantage or to be ignored. He should never buy or sell becouse and after the stock went up or down significantly. One of the most important rules with funds too is to buy bellow net asset value and above. Five elements determin how much should we pay for a stock and it´s future: 1, long term prospects, 2, management quality, 3, financial strenght, 4, divident record, 5, current dividend rate. Problems to watch for at a company: company is a serial aquirer, big borrowers, customer concentration. Good signs of a company: wide moat, marathoner not a sprinter, significant RnD. Never take a single years earning seriously. PE can be difficult to compare becouse of different reasons e.g. use of one time special charges, income tax adjustment becouse of past losses, or diluting shares. So the pro-forma earnings (~non-GAAP) exclude certain costs that a company believes result in a distorted picture, but the intelligent investor should completely ignore this metric. The basic recommendation is that a stock portolfio should have an overall E/P (PE invesrse) ratio at least as high as high as the high grade bond (~AA) rate. - Right now in 2022 Aug Corp AA is 3.96% so a stock portfolio should be around 25.2 EP - The current price reflects both known facts and the future expectations, which is a double basis for market valuations. Based on that, there are two different approaches to security analyis. First, the predictive approach that also be called qualitative apprach, emphasizes prospects, management, an other non-neasurable but important future factors. The second, protective or quantitative approach amphasizes the measurable relationships between selling price and earnings, assets, dividends, etc. The balance between the two aspects is highly controversial, the conservative investor should just focus on diversification and simple rules. Adequate size e.g. over 2B, Financial strenght e.g. 2 to 1 current ratio (current assets 2x or higher than liabilities), earnings stability, dividend record, earnings growth, moderate PE (Graham recommends 15 ?!), moderate price to book (Graham recommends max 1,5) (try to multiply the PE with the price to book and keep it under 22.5). Always read the proxy statement of the company that you own: it is sent to every stakeholder, announces the agenda of the annual meeting, compensation and ownership of managers, and transactions with insiders. Share buybacks are great in theory, unfortunately in the real world share buybacks can only be descibed as a sinister: they cover executive compensation and companies don´t want to issues new shares and dilute earnings figures so companies repurchase shares on the open market at any price. Daniel Kahneman on good decisions: 1, well calibarated confidence (do I understand things as well as I think I do?) 2, correctly anticipated regret (how will I react if my analysis turns out to be wrong?) Many argue that the stock market become more efficient than in Graham´s time and stock prices reflect everything what is known about the company and the economy, so value investing is outdated. However, investors following Graham like Warren Buffett are consistently outperforming the market - says buffett. It´s like millions of investors who toss coins to make buy and sell decisions... and some of them become millionairs by chance. Hower, most of these investoros follow the same Graham school.	Very outdated from 50+ years ago, but the new comments were made 20 years ago. It exteremly powerful to see the big picture and learn how to invest like a business not like in a casino. Interesting to understand the mean etc.	finished	***
Wealth, War and Wisdom Book by Barton Biggs		Thomas Rowe Price Jr., an investment banker, is popularly known for defining the concept of growth stocks. War is good for commodity prices, but terrible in most other times. Gold stores value for long term and works again hyperinflation in most countries, inlcuding occupied e.g. Italy and France, but produces no real return. However for shorter perdiods e.g. couple of years and smaller inflation it often fails to track inflation. Real estate is often confiscated or bombed under war but farmland and land in general works well, except for Japan where it was confiscated too. Bonds are often the worst in crysis and also bad in inflationary periods. Stocks produce real return and store even value, protect against some form of infaltion but uccupied countries often close stock exchanges and owership can be confistaced, and even if not then it is hard to liquidate in need. Fine art is dangerous to keep, easy to burn or damage in a war but jewelry proved to be an excellent to exchange for anything altough in a fraction of the cost base.	Good historic overview of what worked in the past.	finished	***
The Changing World Order: Why Nations Succeed and Fail	Ray Dalio	Cycles of nations repeat with similar patterns, suprisingly with similar frequency e.g. 150 years from raise to fall wich is rooted in human psychology of a few subsequent generations. Tech acceleration did not chance this much. It is typical that returns on investments of failing empires decline relative to the rising empire. Current USD based monetary sytem was established by an agreement after the 2nd world war in Bretton Woods, and linked the USD to Gold. The foundation of Americal culture is "give me liberty of death" while in China or Asian cultures personal liberty is not nearly as important compared to the collective stability. For the same reason the geneal population accepts to have wise leaders making decisionsas the general population is less informed. Democracies are prone to prone slip in dyfunctional anarchies during difficult times. There are 3 big cycles: debt cycle, internal order cycle, external order cycle. Determinants: education (one of the first ones to go up), innovation, cost competitiveness, military, trade, economic output, financial centers, reserve currency status (one of the most important one and last one to go down in falling empires) Additional determinants: geology, resource allocation efficiency, acts of nature, infrastructure, character and civility, rule of law. Ray believes that we have about 5-10 years till the big cycles will reach a more instable phase when the power of China and the US will start to be more equal and conflicts might escalate. Part of the reason is that altough the chineese GPD per capita will be still only one third of the US but with 3 times larger population.	An outstanding birds eye level view on em	finished	****

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Range: Why Generalists Triumph in a Specialized World	David Epstein	Kind (repetive, clear rules) vs wicked learning environments needs very different approaches. AI is better in tactical calculations but big picture startegy needs GAI or human with range. Learning environments, where students struggle less, with more precedural task and more repetitive tests, feel better and prerform better, but in fact produce much less lasting learning effects. Learning environments where students struggle more, where tests are less repetitive and require abstraction and generalisation produce lower immediate results and dissatisfaction but end more lasting and more broadly applicable learning. This leads to controversies e.g. students might perform worse on test these days in the school but the learning will be more lasting. The most successfull problem solvers first categorize the type of problem based on the characteristis to find a good analogue and way to approach it, instead of looking at the problem itself. Seth Godin descibed that career high achievers dare to guit and quit often without bad feelings if they recognize that the opportunity is not a great fit. The trick is to recognize fast when it is about the lack of persistence and or the misfit compared to better other opportunities around. This again confirms that delaying choices of specailisation leads later better fits. The broadly used GRIT scale measureung capabilities of persistence and focus might have a predicitve value for success, however exceptional achievers are more often the ones who are not afraid of chaning often until they find a great quality match for their profile. It is an ancient wistom that you get know yourself though experience and trying yourself out in different roles. Many nobel prize winning discoveries were born as Friday night hackatons etc. where scientists were encouraged to play freely outside of their circle of competence.	Many-many anecdotes to make a few inter	finished	***
Measure What Matters: OKRs	John Doerr	Inspirational OKRs vs Comitted OKRs Quality and Quantity OKRs must go in pairs		Finished	***
2021					
The Snowball: Warren Buffett and the Business of Life	Peter Lynch	"Praise by name criticize by category" "Don`t ask a barber if you need a haircut" Compounding Margin of safety Protecting principal	Too long and detail oriented, but deep insights.	finished	***
The Motley Fool Investment Guide	Tom Gartner			finished	****
One Up On Wall Street	Peter Lynch			finished	****
100 Baggers	Christopher W. Mayer	1, You Have to Look for Them: "When looking for the biggest game, be not tempted to shoot at anything small." You only have so much time and so many resources to devote to stock research. Focus your efforts on the big game: The elephants. The 100-baggers. 2, Growth, Growth and More Growth: You want to focus on growth in sales and earnings per share. 3, Lower Multiples Preferred: Great stocks have a ready fan club, and many will spend most of their time near their 52-week highs, as you'd expect. It is rare to get a great business at dirt-cheap prices. If you spend your time trolling stocks with price–earnings ratios of five or trading at deep discounts to book value or the like, you're hunting in the wrong fields— at least as far as 100-baggers go. You may get lucky there, of course, but the targets are richer in less austere settings. 4, Economic Moats Are a Necessity: A 100-bagger requires a high return on capital for a long time. A moat, by definition, is what allows a company to get that return. 5, Smaller Companies Preferred: Start with acorns, wind up with oak trees. The median sales figure of the 365 names in the study was about $170 million. 6, Owner-Operators Preferred: Having a great owner-operator also adds to your conviction. I find it easier to hold onto a stock through the rough patches knowing I have a talented owner-operator with skin in the game at the helm. 7, You Need Time: Use the Coffee-Can Approach as a Crutch: Once you do all this work to find a stock that could become a 100-bagger, you need to give it time. Even the fastest 100-baggers in our study needed about five years to get there. A more likely journey will take 20–25 years. 8, You Need a Really Good Filter: Don't fret so much with guesses as to where the stock market might go. Keep looking for great ideas. If history is any guide, they are always out there. 9, Luck Helps: Just as in life, so in the pursuit of 100-baggers. Good luck helps. 10, You Should Be a Reluctant Seller: If the job has been correctly done when a common stock is purchased, the time to sell it is—almost never. Sell if: You've made a mistake—that is, "the factual background of the particular company is less favorable than originally believed." The stock no longer meets your investment criteria. You want to switch into something better—although an investor should be careful here and only switch if "very sure of his ground."		finished	
Cribsheet: A Data-Driven Guide to Better, More Relaxed Parenting, from Birth to Preschool	Emily Oster	Watching TV seem to bring any value or harm over 3 years, earlier kids do not pick up much. Large part of the harm is opportunty lost during TV hours. There are huge differences when kids start speaking. There is a correlation with IQ etc later if starting earlier or later, but the predicitve value is little. At 18 months says about 10-100 words. Boys and multilanguage kids start later. (So what is Filip with over 500 at 18?!)	Finally a new type of guide: not anecdote but data driven.	reading	****
Secrets of the Baby Whisperer	Melinda Blau and Tracy Hogg	Too many...	Little oldscool and anecdote driven, but one of the most popular books for average crowd. Probaby there are many better books.	finished	**
2020					
The Wim Hof Method: Activate Your Full Human Potential	Wim Hof , Elissa Epel PhD	Cold exposure and hyperventilation do medical miracles: managing altitue sickness, immune response, heat regulation, Different type of breating techniques for athletic performance, mood regulation: e.g. 4-4-4-4, Tumo, power breathing. Simple cold exposure for beginners: 1-2 minutes cold shower a day.	Too much charismatic bullshit, but the cold exposure and breathing techniques are simple and powerful, if not eyeopening.	finished	***
Narrative Economics: How Stories Go Viral and Drive Major Economic Events	Robert J. Shiller	Economic memes also have super-spreaders like in pandemics. It is proven that it is a chatoic and random process which narratives are emerging, wich assett classess become favourites etc. E.g.is has been proved that way though wich music hits emerge is completely random and chaotic.	Not that many original insights.	reading	***
Breath: The New Science of a Lost Art	James Nestor	Mounth breathing is very bad for overall health. Both overbreathing or underbreathing can be source of problems or great results: most benefitial seems to be if you breath less is general intentionally but occasioanlly hyperventilate.	Really good for summarizing all the different schools and techniques from Holotropic breathing to Tumo but does not go too much into the details beyond a few specific laboratory test.	finished	***
The Expectant Father: The Ultimate Guide for Dads-to-Be	Armin A. Brott , Jennifer Ash	Too many...	A pregnancy book witten for fathers.	finished	***
Ten Drugs: How Plants, Powders, and Pills Have Shaped the History of Medicine	Thomas Hager	Opium, vaccination, antibiotics, antipsychotic, viagra, statin, monoclonal anitbodies, etc.	A few entartaining stories.	finished	***
I Contain Multitudes: The Microbes Within Us and a Grander View of Life	Ed Yong		Amazing stories on the heterogenous impacts.	reading	****
2019					
Factfulness: Ten Reasons We're Wrong About The World - And Why Things Are Better Than You Think	Hans Rosling , Ola Rosling , Anna Rosling Rönnlund	Need to summarize notes.	The book is not that well written but highlights some important macro trends really well.	finished	*****
The Headspace guide meditation and mindfulness	Andy Puddicombe		Super good light reading on becoming a monk and back.	Reading	****
Gut	Giulia Enders			Reading	
Enlightment now	Steven Pinker	Notes.	Great book, very long, many notes.	finished	****

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The culture map	Erin Meyer	Communication With Asian: confirm the message 3 times, emphasize the culture as a reason Feedback With Asian: blur the message through longer time, deliver it over drinks, leave the negative out completely and just describe the context around it, e.g. talking “about what went really well and what we should continue doing” Argumentation Asian cultures are neither inductive nor deductive, this concept are signs of specific thinking. Asian cultures tend to think holistically, more focus on the macro picture and the dependencies between objects. E.g. Surname in names, year in dates, etc comes first. Selling an idea with the big picture, not specific goals. Common low is the inductive way to think about law, application first. EU law system, Roman law is deductive, principles firs. Multiculture for innovation, monoculture for speed. In international teams have as little ppl work across cultures as possible, and have some more experienced leaders to bridge in between. Hierarchy Power distance is the measure of respect and authority between different levels. In Asian hierarchies, based on Cunfucian tradition, there is a mutual responsibility between superior and inferior. The boss is a paternalistic figure. In mixed culture teams the rules e.g. for mail CC should be defined upfront. How to solicit feedback in hierarchical cultures: ask the team to give feedback, ask ppl way in advance of the meeting to collect their thoughts. Decision making In some cultures strict hierarchies work with consensus based decisions which is seemingly counterintuitive (e.g. German, even stronger in Japan), egalitarian cultures where boss decides quickly and everyone lines up (US). Japanese ringi: lower levels discuss, make decision, and boss only approves. Business trust Emotional / relationship vs cognitive / task based cultures: in the USA clearly separated, not in Asia and in most countries where judical system is not that mature. The relationship is the contract. Peach vs coconut culture. In Japan team harmony and avoiding open conflict can be more important than goals. Daytime they are task based, night time they are relationship based. Night time discussions should not be mentioned during the day. More alcohol, kareoke, or baths shows how you let your guard down and become trustworthy. Conflict management French like to debate and disagree openly. Asian cultures have to keep face value and image, and act in line with the cunfucian roles and responsibilities (father sun, husband wife, older younger sibling, etc) to avoid social disorder, which is more important than truth. This is strongest in Japan, where attacking an idea and attacking a person is the same. In Japan ppl do not even express own opinion when boss is there, and as soon as his opinion is known that will count. Meetings are more for publicizing a decision that was made upfront. Anonymous post its and dot votes work better on meetings to brainstorm. Time management Linear time focused vs. event based flexible. Chinese are punctual with time almost like Japanese but they are overly flexible with planning.	A very practical model to view cross cultural leadership and organisations. My notes reflect a very specific interest in some specific cultures.	finished	*****
Educated	Tara westover		The reader was great, the story dramatic, poetic, psychologically, sciologically and culturally very interesting. I did not like the ending though, it turned out the writer was just a telented person angry about her disfunctional and uneducated family, and it was easier to have a ravenge than to fix it.	finished	***
Four futures	Peter Frase	Write	Four very different but not impossible futures. More of a study than a science fiction.	finished	****
2018		Keywords: spirituality, fiction			
Foundation	Isaac Asimov	“Violence is the last refuge of the incompetent.”	Entertaining science fiction, with some inspirational messages. Good for before sleep.	finished	***

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21 Lessons for the 21st Century	Yuval Noah Harari	Social pressures these days visible in politics and populism are not a result of an exploited class going against a ruling elite like before but a class that is not needed anymore. Fighting against becoming meaningless might be impossible. Nationalists of Brexit, Putin, Ortodox Jews, ISIS, are dreaming of resurrecting the lost independent empire which sounds a fantasy in the hyperconnected 21st century. We should not compare a single human to a single AI but a whole system: all AI doctors can be upgraded and learn at once, self driving cars are communicating with each other to avoid crash, etc. So it makes sense to clean humans from certain job functions entirely even if individual humans do better. Medical diagnostics could be practically free on a better level then the best available today. Jobs requiring emotions and human connection like nursing would be much more difficult to disrupt. It is not the most successful product that is the best but the one that google ranks first. There are experts on Googles taste who optimise for product for that… Universal basic income is about to redefine value and jobs. One problem is that the developing countries cannot afford that, and even if their unskilled workers loose jobs the employees cannot transition to other jobs. Nobody will need them and nobody will pay them. Jobless ortodox jews report highlef levels of satisfaction than any other segment of the israeli society and this is becouse of their social bonds and the deep meaning they find in studying scripts. They seem to be a fossile now but they might be a new model. Democratic referendums are always about feelings, not rational. Otherwise there wiuld be no reason to give all people voting rights on everything. Democracy assumes that free will is a misterious ultimate authority. Orwell 1984 predicted that TV will watch us not we watch the TV. It is a pefect tool to assess our personality types while observing our reactions. Tesla-alturist and tesla-egoist self driving models could become available based on the customers choice. Decentralisation was necessary for complex social systems becouse humans were the bottleneck, but AI works better with more data and centralisation so the trend might change. Authoritarian regimes' disadvantages might become a decisive advantage. Politics will be about to control data flows of society. We dont have much routine in regulating data like we have with IP or real estate. Online social platforms should encourage offline connecting people and build communities. However they make their money from attention merchandising so they are not incentivized to bring people off-line. The clash of civilizations theory is not true because humans do not act as species, they can merge, they don't have a fixed DNA that they can transfer, they are in constant change and eveyone has a different interpretation of e.g. Islam. Global politics and the Olympics are the best examples of getting more globalized instead of clashing. Civilisations are specialising in certain things and can be very different but standardising ways how to connect and trade. Cultures are easier to be defined by the conflicts and dillemmas in their value system instead of the core values that they agree on. In the 20th century with the nuclear warfare countries realized that higher level globalism is necessary to avoid global nuclear catastrophy and nationalism was pushed back. However recent years nationalism has came back because we forget how for example the European Union contributed to global peace. Besides nuclear warfare another problem that requires global solutions and cannot be solved by nationalist is the global ecological crisis and the claimant to change. Artificially produced meet in laboratories will be cheaper than industrialized farming meet in about a decade. The problem of technology disruption like artificial intelligence is the third problem, big problem of the world that cannot be managed by nationalist ideas. The most interesting approach to deal with global problems like the ecological disruption, nuclear warfare and technology disruption is the European Union. It is a union of countries preserving their identity while harmonizing their actions in order to address global problems. Celebrating the uniqueness of the nation is required for the unite people. The trick is to balance local identity and loyalty for a family, for the country, for a party etc with our global obligations to avoid the end of mankind. Science has an advantage over religion in that it can learn, admit failure. This is the reason the scientific approach is in agriculture, in healthcare etc were adopted by every country even the most relegious ones. The EUs immigration crisis is becouse of its success with dealing with multiculturalimsm. The 3 debates of immigration: 1, allow immigrants in at all and if yes who? 2, do immigrants need to embrace the core values of the host even if they give up theirs? 3, does assimilation mean they become full citizens? We are in the age of culturism not racism anymore. It seems it is more tolerant but more critical too becouse it is vague. What is muslim culture? Totally different interpretations through thousand years. Terrorism is driven by fear, and there is an extreme disproportion between casulties and fear. If you add all people killed in EU since 1945 in terrorist attacks it is less then any significant battles in the world war. Around the most intense palestine terror attacks on israel still more israelis died in car accidents. Terrorism seems to be big now only because we do not have bigger problems, wars, violence, etc. All social animals have ethical codes for cooperation, e.g. often helping weak members. Christianity splitted from judeism based on general commandments, Christianity is a choice on a universal ethic not for a tribe. But others like cunfucius tought universal ethics long before. In the big religions often the cosmic mistery was simply replaced by a caregiving lord figure of god then non logical rules and tabos were attributed to it. Relegion is not a condition for moral behaviour. Secular countries are not more violent, social animals have moral code. Deep appreciation of unnecesary suffering and commitment to avoid it is enough. Secular education teaches children to distinguish facts form beliefs, think freely, develop appreciation for wisdom. It does not lack etics or social responsibility, it is only too complicated especially in difficult times. In our overly complex in connected world the moral imperative becomes to KNOW things to be able to make more informed decisions. We seem to have entered the post truth era, the age of disinformation. But in fact this is a very human skill, the ability to create and spread fictions enabled us to conquare the world and build large scale collaborations since stone age: relegions, gods, demons, witches, nations, etc. When millions believe fake news it becomes relegion. Some relegions believe in leaner meaning of life, e.g communism is about rising of the proletariate leading to ruling, or jews from biblic times to getting back mother land and later ruling the world. Every individual understands that together with his simole role in the whole story, every act every day has a meaning. But these stories only cover meaningless amount of people, timescales, etc in the face of the billion years of universe and size of the universe, and becomes dangerous by ignoring other perspectives, orther tribes whole believe in other stories.		finished	*****

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Why We Sleep: Unlocking the Power of Sleep and Dreams	Matthew Walker PhD	Even mimosa has circadian clock, and does not depend on the sun. Human circardian cycle is slighly longer than 24 hours, on average 24h 15min, sometimes 25-26, but many little factors e.g. light resets it daily. That is one of the reasons for that jetleg is easier to manage towards west, as it makes our day even longer. Melatonin is the trigger that helps us fall asleep easier and comes periodically, whereas Adenosine the accumulating throughout all waking hours and result in am increasing sleep pressure. But the two are completely disconnected. Hot bath before sleep dilutes blood vessels and helps dropping core tempreture faster which helps sleeping in general, and more deep REM sleep too. The Rat brain replys maze learning pattern during REM sleep, but it slower (half or quarter) then real time, this shows the diluted time experience in dreams. Waking hours are about perception, NREM sleep is about cleaning up space, transmitting to storage, interpretation, REM is about integrating and embedding information. Deep NREM is the last phase before REM sleep (NREM can be 1-2-3), produces exceptional slow brainwaves with large amplitude, as neurons sync. REM is similar brainwave to awake, that is when we dream, but we have zero muscle tone to materialize the dreamer motions. Being awake can be considered an evolutionary more developed state of mind and came later in evolution than sleep states. REM sleep is only present in mammals and birds, however REM sleep is not present in some whales and there are many more outliers in length and patterns for unknown reason. It seems that birds and mammals developed REM totally separately twice during evolution which shows an evolutionary pressure and the need for it. This is similar to how the pair of eyes eyes where developed independently. The mid afternoon tiredness and sleep is part of our natural cycle, the biphasic sleep is natural. It has been proved in a 6 yeas study that abandoning siesta increases cardiovascular risks by 30-60 percentage! The REM sleep is important for brain development and and for proper integration of experiences, autist have no normal sleep patterns and REM which can be one of the important resons for their challanges. Teens circadian cycle is different, shifted towrds night and later go to sleep. Maybe this is an evolutionary trick to help disconnect from parents. Sleep spindles (bursts of oscillation in NREM 2), even naps clear out short term memory into long term storage and free up space. The NREM phases are dominant in early night sleeep, and especially deep NREM sleep helps the memory, more correlates in better recall rate. Brainwave stimulation in NREM phase increases memory recall rate (both electric and sound stimulation works), but doing the same in REM phases does not help. Sleep and practice together are the “muscle memory”, mastering something naturally, like playing music. Every aspect of athletic performance drops with bellow 8 hours of sleep: aerob, anaerob, cooling, power etc. and even injury risk increases. Each hour of sleep loss correlates with exponentially growing risk of accident while driving, 15-20 hours of not sleeping equals being drunk for driving in terms of reaction time etc. and self assesment is extremely inaccurate. Stidies show that having multiple nights 5 hours of sleep, or one night of sleep deprivation have simlar brain consequences in loosing the balance withween logical thinking and emotions. Surveys show 60% increase in flight or fight response from amygdala. The balance between the prefrontal cortex and amygda, the break and the gas gets disconnected. The brain is unable to put expereinces in a broader, logical context, and more primitive emotional reactins become dominant, both negative and positive emotional swings become stornger. Sleep deprivation or circadian disruption is a causal factor of cancer, cardiovascular, diabates many other diseases, through several mechanisms. The World Health Organisation already categorises night shift jobs carcinogenic. Even one night if not sleeping, like the day after daylight saving time can be shown with statistics to cause more (or less) medical incidents on the following day. In a clinical test with sleep deprived individuals, after sleeping only 4 hours a night for a 6 days, their body processed standard those of glucose 40% slower, and their blood sugar test levels are equal to prediabetics. Sleep deprived individuals experience different hormone levels related to hunger (e.g. Endocannabinoid) and therefore consume significantly more calories than they would need (one study showed that 600 kalories more). The reason for craving for food is mainly because the brain cannot connect the lower level instinctive with the higher level control of the pre-frontal cortex. However as soon as you get back to your normal sleep the connection is established and the control of the pre-frontal cortex is reestablished. Study showed that randomised pictures of subjects with normal sleep and sleep deprived has a huge correlation with the subjective attractiveness. Sleep or sleep deprivation is also shown to be highly correlated with the immune response, for example seasonal flu is much more likely to be caught by sleep deprived individuals. The immune response to vaccination is also significantly dependent on the sleep averages of the person around the days of vaccination. Interestingly, it was showen that even if the person sleeps well for weeks afther vaccination the immune system response will not be sufficient, and the damage can be measured even after one of vaccination. Only one night with 4 hours sleep makes 70% of the natural killer cells desappear in healthy young man, these are the immuce cells targeting malignant tumor cells. Sleep deprivation affects core moleular biology processess e.g. gene expression or DNA stability. A recent EU study showed that regular 6 hours or less sleap increases the chance for cancer by about 40%. compared to 7+ hours sleepers, the decreased amount of sleep was found to be correlated to the cancer metastatis and aggressivness of breast cancer. Based on systematic review ti seems that dreams are not a whole reply of our waking lifes, only few percent reappeards in dreams ("day residue"). However, up to 50% of the emotional concerns of the day reappear in dreams based on dream reports. Fruedian interpretation... Sleep is the only time then our brain doesn’t have noradrenaline, the key stress hormone. This means that when we are dreaming in REM we are reprocessing the daytime activities but without stress hormones, without emotions. This experience helps us processing our own experiences and get rid of the emotional stress and help integrating them. It is like an introspective life review, a overnight therapy. There is evidence that post traumatic stress syndrome is partially caused by the unusually elevated levels of noradrenaline during night. This means that individuals cannot process their painful emotional experience at night and getting the results. They new PTSD theory says that if the emotional pain is too significant than the individual is not able to enter normal REM sleep and go through the overnight therapy function, becouse of the elevated stress hormones, and this just continues. It seems that the awake brain operates with a strict focus and only recalls tightly realted memories like a telescope, whereas the brain in REM dream state is not that restriced, solves problems with a hyper associative approach and sees memories like a wide lens. REM dream state can connect different associations that we do not connect waking hours, we are able to solve problems, come up with diagnoses, children with new grammatical structures, etc. during night. Tests showed that subjects woken up from their REM sleep phase solved creative problem very different and more effective ways. In tests for creative problem solving it seems that particpant have 3 times higher chance to find a solution if they sleep than if they work on the problem awake. "Sleep on the problem" is a term that is universally used by many languages. Sleep paralysis can happen in health individuals. It means that the individual wakes up from REM sleeping but the body does not get released by the paralysis. Cataplexy is the phenomena when an individual collapses and falls into paralysis by strong emotional effects. This is the malfunction of their sleep system, in hypothlamus as the sleep-weak switch with a hormone Orexin malfunctions. They only cure is it the patient lives at perfectly stable emotionally, no ups and downs		finished	*****

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Bad Blood Secrets and Lies in a Silicon Valley Startup	John Carreyrou		*"The full inside story of the breathtaking rise and shocking collapse of Theranos, the multibillion-dollar biotech startup."*	finished	***
How to Change Your Mind	Michael Pollan	Merck patented mdma in 1912 and forgot it. The first psychomimetic paradigm assumed that psychedelics mimic the effects of psychosis like skizophrenia. This proved to be wrong. The psycholitic paradigm assumed that the substance relaxes ego defensenses and gives insights to the subconscious. However they were too unpredictible. Psychedelics acts as active placebos, they do something but it is mostly self generatd. Stanislav Grov says they are non specific amplifiers of menthal processes. L. Hubbard and Aldus Huxley helped reconceptualizing LSD experince under the psychedelic paradigm. Empecs (??) was the worlds first psychedelic corporation in Silicon Valley, regularly administering LSD for employees. “Mother of all Demos“ by Doug Engelbart (??) in 1968: after James Fadiman LSD experiemnt with engineers, scientists and artists he invented computer mouse, computer GUI, text editor, hypertext, email, video conferencing, etc. and demonstarted all at once. One of the most important learnings of the 60ties was that altough psychedlic drugs are powerful ancient medicines they can be harmful withouth social containers, rituals and an expert like a shaman. We just did not learn from this societies and traditions becouse they are considered older, inferior. DMT, LSD, PSYLOCIN are triptamins, consisting of two rings, they typically act as signaling molecules. The most famous one in the human body is serotonin, most classic psychedelic bind to some serotonin receptors, LSD with even stronger affinity. fMRI showed that psylocybin reduces activity of the default mode network, DMN. The DMN was discovered in 2001, which was the most active part of the brain while fMRI subjects were just waiting for the doctors instructions and did nothing. The DMN is mostly active when doing self reflection, moral reasoning, mental time travel, all sorts of higher level meta cognitive processes. It is the domain that acts as an orchestrator, exhibits inhibitory influence over the lower level older parts of the brains. Entropic brain theory: the childhood consciousness is similar in sime ways to the brain on psychedelics, lacking experiences and self reflection, wich is like a lathern, attention is widely diffused. This is very different from an adult consciousness, wich is specific as a spotlight, consciousness with a goal. A child has no previous priors to interpret experiences and search for assiciations. Supressing the DMN allows brain domains to connect without the orchestrator. Terminally ill patients have an overactive DMN as their Ego is preoccupied with self reflection, temporarely supressing it helps a lot. The brains visual cortex lights up under fFMRI both in case if the subject imagings or really sees something. It seems that during waking hours the brain prevents the visual cortex from presenting the images to consciousness, which is nit the case while dreaming or tripping. Posterior singulate cortex is one of the key structures of the DMN, measurable with brain scans. It links prefrontal cortex and hypocampus, it is believed to nurture attachments or addictions, and host ego amkng other things.	History, medical backround, and self exploration on psychedelic compunds (LSD, psylocibin, DMT) by a great journalist. Very entertaining and comprehensive reading for everyone.	finished	****
The Book of Why: The New Science of Cause and Effect	Judea Pearl	Ladder of Causation: we can prove mathematically that there are 3 different levels of causal reasing models. 1, association Animals or computers with observation, pattern recocognition What happens with Y if I see X? How are the variables related? 2, intervention Children with doing, having a causal theory What if I do X? How can i make Y happen? 3, counterfactuals Adults with imagination of fictious worlds, reasoning in and about non existing worlds What if I had done X? Cognitive revolution, that lead to imagination, hypothesises Strong AI is not possible without that. The first archeological sign of that is about 40k years old sculpture, the “Lion Man” from cave in Germany, an imaginary creature, a precursor of evey philisophical, scientific, relegious etc theory. In a causal network a node with two independent parents makes those parents statistically connected. The negative correlation is sometimes called collider bias or the “explain-away” effect. Our brains are not wired to do probability problems, but they are wired to do causal problems. And this causal wiring produces systematic probabilistic mistakes, like optical illusions. If there is no causal connection between two variables either directly or through a common cause, we find it utterly incomprehensible that there is a probabilistic association. Our brains are not prepared to accept causeless correlations, we need to learn to recognize collider structures. “Correlation does not imply causation”. The way that we obtain information is no less important than the information itself. Without a randomized controlled trial, there was no way to convince skeptics like Yerushalmy and R. A. Fisher, who were committed to the idea that the observed association between smoking and lung cancer was spurious. In certain circles there is an almost religious faith that we can find the answers to questions in the data itself, if only we are sufficiently clever at data mining. However, readers of this book will know that this hype is likely to be misguided. They require us to formulate a model of the process that generates the data, or at least some aspects of that process. Anytime you see a paper or a study that analyzes the data in a model-free way, you can be certain that the output of the study will merely summarize, and perhaps transform, but not interpret the data. When we start talking about strong AI, causal models move from a luxury to a necessity.	Turing-prize winning mathematician finally explains the "causal revolution", the new mathematical approach to model our world and build artificial intelligence. For non-mathematicians, in human readable format. Good amount of history, tons of super difficult math brain teasers, lot of statistical theory, few practical applications. A must read to anyoe interested in strong AI and not only the hype.	finished	****
The Phoenix Project: A Novel about IT, DevOps, and Helping Your Business	Gene Kim	Imporance of categorizing work. In manufacturing and IT four types of work: business projects, internal projects, change management, unplanned work. Corporations made money by moving goods, but now they make money by moving bits. IT Risk are business risks. IT Security by default works against business unless objectives are created in smart ways. Feedback loops between orgs are key to progress and aligment. Knowledge and skill monopolization, even if with one key person (Bert in the book), can create a bottleneck for a whole company. The throughput of the business is at it at its bottleneck, this was true for manufacturing and still true for IT. Investing in anything else than removing the bottleneck is pointless. Bert had to write down everything he does. Discover the bottlenecks throgh Kanban and process mapping. Effectively mnaged IT is a predictor of company performance. IT leaders can only be effective if they turly understand the business and talk to everyone in the business.	DevOps bible. Fiction story of an IT operations vice president and his permanent fire fighting. More adrenalin than in an action movie.	finished	****
Principles: Life and Work	Ray Dalio	For your life: “Meaningful work and meaningful relationships.” For your job: “imolement radical transparency and learn thoughtful disagreement”. Write down your own principles.	The funder of world largest privately owned hedge fund, Bridgewater Associates (managing 150B+ USD) explaining his work and life principles. Sometimes a bit dry, sometimes a bit bullshit, sometimes a bit trivial... but overall worth the reading.	finished	***

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Why Buddhism Is True: The Science and Philosophy of Enlightenment	Robert Wright	Rage is evolutionary beneficial only in small societies. Feeling rage agains or taking revenge on an other driver feels good but is unproductive. Recognising it is liberating. The snake perception illusion is almost always false, but it was designed like that to save life. Natural selection did not design the mind to see the world clearly. It designed to take care of the genes. Default mode network of the brain is the part of the brain that is active when we are not doing anything. There are two typical topics: fantasizing about the future and pondering recent events, never experiencing the present moments. It is difficult to abandon the default mode network if there is nothing to focus on. If you manage that you experience a deep peace.If you manage that you experience a deep peace. 2 basic meditative paths: mindfulness and concentration. 7th and 8th parts of the 8 Buddhist paths. Mindfulness: not distancing too much but also not too close to our experiences. Not self = self is a false illusion. Intellectualising the concept is impossible, achievable only through experiencing by meditation. 5 Buddhist aggregates of the Self. Are any of these the self? 1, physical body or form: eyes, ears... 2, basic feelings 3, perceptions: identifiable sights or sounds 4, mental formations: complex emotions, toughts 5, consciousness: knowing about all the others Buddha firs argument against self: Which is of these show the qualities of what you expect from the self? Like being able to control it. None of them are completely under our controll. Body misbehaves and even causes us to suffer. We do not have ordinary control over feeleings either. Etc. Or should we expect from the self to be in control like a CEO? Is the self the one in control or the one under control? Our self is not in control either. Intertemporal utility function and time discounting: it is the level of willingness to delay gratificatin or or give up today in favour of a bigger one tomorrow, seem to be the most a permanent atribute of our psychological makeup that we are born with. But it is possible to manipulate it, eg. for men by showing pictures of attractive women or even just being in different mood. Buddha second argument against the self: it does not make sense to say that something is the self if it is not permanent. Buddha: if you cannot control part of your self and causes suffering then just stop identifying with it. Sayings for 3 meditation traditions: zen is for poets pondering criptic lines, vipassana (or mindfullness which is the main vehicle of vipassana) is for psychologists is a good way to obeserve and study the modules of our own mind, tibetian is for artists often steering the mind towards visual imagery. Thoughts actually think themselves: thoughts are generated by brain modules, the strongest reaches consciousness and even hijack it. Feelings are the measure how thoughts stick to consciousness, a trick how mind assigns priorities to them. RAIN: recognize the harmful feeling, accept, investigate, non identify. Dont feed the greedy animals in you becouse they will keep coming back for more. Formlessness or emptiness (mahajana) :feelings how we attach to the Essence of the objects, and we create that meaning. More expensive vine tastes better, our enemies are bad, fundamental attribution error, cognitive bias... our perception is faded by our feelings toward the essence we believe the object or person holds. It is even questionable if an objective thing exists separately from the perception. Taking out essence - how does that effect positive feelings like love towards others, or even an offspring? Weakens? In some ways, but it rather tends to help allocating feelings more consciously, not towards a single person. Can it lead to feel less about people and do bad things with them? Does not tend to do that but no guarantees ("upper east side zen predator)". Buddha couples contemplation with moral instructions. What about joy? What is the difference between a vegetable and an enlightened buddhist? You still have your feelings but you can decide which one to embrace and follow, selective engagament. Meditation is almost like a rebellion agains the robot overloards of the Matrix in the science fiction movie that create the illusions that guides us, or rebellbion against our creator = natural selection. It wants us to spread genes, this is its value system. However these illusions like craving for more food do not even serve the original purpose anymore. But we have the power to deliberate ourselves. Natural selection also says I am special, more special than others. Then I can decide if I want to believe him, and if i want to be angry if an other person disturbs me. 5 reasons to meditate: moments of truth when i recognize objective facts like sounds, moments of more consequential truth when i recognize how i relate to things and change, wisdom of clarity e.g. not reacting emotionally, moments of moral truth e.g. understanding the other person perspective too, timely interventions e.g. understanding where my feelings are coming from getting rid of them if needed. Meta cognitive revolution is maybe unavoidable, similarly to the cognitive revolution, when a critical mass will start understanding themselves and overcome the psychology of tribalism, (politics, racism, religion etc forces that pull the world apart) which was the main motivation of the book.	*"From one of America's greatest minds, a journey through psychology, philosophy, and lots of meditation to show how Buddhism holds the key to moral clarity and enduring happiness."*	finished	****
Sapiens: A Brief History of Humankind	Yuval Noah Harari	312§	*"From a renowned historian comes a groundbreaking narrative of humanity's creation and evolution - a number one international best seller - that explores the ways in which biology and history have defined us and enhanced our understanding of what it means to be "human"."*	finished	*****

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Scale: The Universal Laws of Growth, Innovation, Sustainability, and the Pace of Life in Organisms, Cities, Economies, and Companies	Geoffrey West	Finite time singularity = accelerating growth cannot be sustained without infinite resources or regular paradigm shifts. However paradigm shifts need to happen also in ever shorter cycles. We might be the last human sapiens generation: next generation will be either upgraded superhuman or dead. Scaling exponent of companies is about 0.9, 0.85 of city infrastructure, 0.75 for organisms. Social brain hypothesis: brain size correlates with social structures, not with size of the animal or cognitive challenges. Although correlation is not causation... Socioeconomic and physical networks both are fractile like, space filling, have invariant terminal units. A major difference is that connections in phys networks is broader on higher levels e.g. blood vesslels, which results in sublinear scaling. In socioeconomic networks the information flow is greatest between terminal units, the people, and lower on family, country etc levels, which results in superlinear scaling. City size = temperature, metabolic rate of the socioeconomic structure Terminal units = people 1 hour max daily commute time for humans has been invariant for thousands of years (Marketes contant?) and seems to play an important role in the architecture of cities. People in larger cities communicate more, which is measurable with cellphone connections, even walk proportionally faster. This is the higher metabolic rate. The social network of a person is invariable, interestingly. Dammar numbers: 5-15-50-150, from close friends to distant ones. The only difference is that in a village these are geographically near. Innovation lifecycle is shorter than human life now, that's why you need to learn throughout whole life.	*"From one of the most influential scientists of our time, a dazzling exploration of the hidden laws that govern the life cycle of everything from plants and animals to the cities we live in."*	finished	***
Saturnin	Zdeněk Jirotka	You are never too old to play. "Dr. Witherspoon used to categorise people according to the way they behaved in a half-empty cafe when confronted by a plate of doughnuts. ... a person without imagination, any dynamic passions or a sense of humour, you will subject the doughnuts to a dull and thoughtless gaze until perhaps midday. ... At the sight of the doughnuts a member of the second category enjoys reflecting on what it would be like if someone, quite out of the blue and without warning, employed these pastries as missiles and began bombarding the other customers in the cafe. ... I would never have believed that a third category of people existed, the members of which are as rare as white crows. I mean those people for whom the idea of a doughnut whistling through the air is such an enticement that they get up and actually make it happen."	Czech classic from 1942, about servant and his absurd stories with an absurd, dry, Czech style humour. The author plays a lot with the formal, unusual language which makes it hard to read.	finished	***
2017		Keywords: history, psychology of relationships, cancer			
The Hero with a Thousand Faces	Joseph Campbell		Psychological analysis of mythologies, a classic book from 1949.The topic seems to be really interesting, but the language is very difficult for a non native speaker.	gave up	
The Lessons of History	Will Durant	The most important historic factor for the prosperity of a nation is the accessability to trade routes. Riverside cities and cultures always prospered, then Mediterranean see side cultures like Greece, then Atlantic nations like Portugal, because of having access to trade. Now flight routes reshape trade routes and in the coming century land mass will be the key to domination. Never the educated cultures inherited the Earth but the fertile ones. Evolutionary processes are more important than anything else. Is the rise and fall of the civilization depend on the inherent qualities of the race? There are definitely many examples that it does not depend on the environmental factors e.g climate or the institutions. It is not the race that makes the civilization but the civilization makes the people. Geographical, political, economical circumstances create a culture then a culture creates a human type with unique culture expressions like language, religion, moral, art etc. Humans from different races living for generations in other cultures take on the new attitudes. Religions are difficult to judge because it is a cultural product of 100 thousand years have gone through natural selection. It is very dangerous for an individual to think that his own individual mind and experience on 50 years can stand up to the wisdom of the race. Maybe it is too difficult to control animal instincts that developed in the proportionally much longer hunting period of mankind against social instincts that have gotten necessary from the agricultural period. The function of moral is to overcome aggressive impulses by social instincts similar to what a family generates. Society is based on social order which is based on moral discipline which is usually related to religious believes, otherwise it is not strong enough. Most civilizations weaken where religious believes weaken, like Greece, Rome, France. If the moral code e.g. of Christianity dies the civilization disintegrates to which it gave social order. Is there any escape? Will does not believe. The age of rational and reason is bit ironic as the many of the most important things in live cannot be reduced to reasoning like feelings, thus rational cannot be a dominant aspect of any age or any man. Rationality is an instrument. Individualistic instincts are always more powerful than social instinct. The definition of sin is overcoming of the social attitudes by the individualistic instincts. Sin is irrelevant without the individual vs social context. Periodic concentration of wealth alleviated by a violent partial redistribution is just a heartbeat of the social organism.	A history professor (who has written the most well know history encyclopedia in the 20st century, "The Story of Civilization", over 10k pages) summarised his learnings in this short book on geography, biology, race, character, morals, religion, economics, socialism, government, war, growth and decay, and progress. Really worth the time!	finished	****

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Homo Deus - A Brief History of Tomorrow	Yuval Noah Harari	In 2010 famine and malnutrition killed about 1M whereas obesity 3M. There are many pathogens but they all rely on luck whereas doctors accumulate knowledge to design more efficient medicine. In ancient times violence was the norm, 15% of deaths were related, now it is under 1% and decreasing. Sugar is more dangerous than gunpowder. The universal declaration of human rights gives the right to live but does not set an age limit. In the US income per capita has doubled for the past 50 years, sex become a non issue with contraceptives, but subjective wellbeing barely increased. We hit some ceiling. Satisfaction is expectation minus reality, but expectations are always increasing over reality. Evolution has wired us to always want more, other phenotypes ("being satisfied with what you have") died out as not being competitive. Biochemical pursuit of happiness, drugs, are only tolerated as long as they help political sability or economical growth. The human brain has been the same for 10 thousands of years, that is why we still understand the bible, that is why history repeats. However, manipulation of the human brain will soon end this era. No clear line separates healing from upgrading our body. A 3 parent baby is possible: the ordinary mother/father, plus a second mother for the mitochondrial DNA. Great loan was always a status symbol. Behaviourist child care schools earlier suggested to maintain discipline in child care and focus only on material needs. More recent studies have shown that monkey babies (mammals) separated from their mothers rather choose hairy objects than metallic food-providing objects. Agriculture disregards emotional needs till these days. All religions found ways to justify human superiority and exploitation of animals. During agricultural revolution humans silenced animals and plants, and the dialogue between man and god become important. Scientific revolution silenced gods too, man is talking to himself and has no obligations anymore. Whereas agricultural revolution gave birth to teist religions, scientific revolution gave birth to humanist religions, in which humans worship humans. The funding idea of humanist religions like communism, liberalism, nazism, is that homo sapience has some secret essence to all the meaning and authority of the universe, and everything can be judged based on the usefulness for humans. In 2002 the famous Gallup survey: 47% of US citizens believes in creationism as bible says, 15% in natural selection, the rest believes in a combination. Consciousness, the stream of subjective experience is not provable, similarly to soul, god etc. but we experience every moment that ours is real. However, it is only possible to prove our owns and we assume it for others. If we take the probabilities for one real world, end endless possible simulated worlds, actually it is more probable that our world is only a simulation. Alan Turing was homosexual and was forced to go through chemical castration in Britain, which led to his suicide. The Turing test was inspired by the gay test of the time. The ability to collaborate in large numbers was and is the key to human superiority, not soul, consciousness, tools, etc. Ultimatum game = one divides the money and the other person accepts the offer or rejects it and nobody gets anything. No reciprocation. Typically people divide it 50:50, offers under 30 get mostly rejected which is not fully rational. 3 types of reality: objective, subjective and inter-subjective. Inter-subjective reality or entity: money, laws, god, nations, Elvis Presley, Apple, Egyptian Faro, VISA, country boarder, certification, football. These make humans superior: using language to create complex new realities. Inter-subjective realities were meant to gave humans a benefit, but we need to think if they are worth if they cause suffering for humans, animals, etc. Religions is created by humans not gods and they are best defined by their social functions. Religion is anything that claims superhuman legitimacy and authority over human social structures, either by gods or natural laws like communism or liberalism or human rights. It is a tool to organise large scale human cooperations. Thus, religion is a deal. Spirituality is a journey. Religions try to cement world orders whereas the goal of the spiritual journey is to escape from them. In Zen buddhism there is a saying: if you meet the Buddha on the road, kill him - which means to decline institutionalised religion and authority. Spiritual journeys are for lonely individuals, not societies, they do not give answers and social structures. Ironically, spiritual leaders e.g. Jesus, Buddha or Luther tend to come up with their own laws and religions. Science seem to gradually replace religion but it does not give answers for ethical questions. Coexistence seem to be healthier until science deals with factual claims and religion deals with ethics. Some philosophers like Sam Harris argue that science can resolve all ethical dilemmas too, because the universal value all humans share is to minimise suffering and maximise happiness, and every ethical debate should be based on facts and science. Modernity is a deal. Humans are giving up meaning in exchange for power. Without god and meaning life does not have a purpose, happy or bad ending, shit happens, nothing is predetermined, suffering does not lead anywhere, hell and paradise is only on Earth. This leads to the most powerful culture with the worst existential crisis. Credit is the economical manifestation of trust in the better or growing future. Most natural processes are zero sum games, thus this assumption is not necessary true but this is the common belief of all modern religions from communism to capitalism. Ancient games like Chess were zero sum, new computer games like Civilisation are about growth, usually about using up the bare minimum resources and invest the maximum possible into the future. The modernity deal kept it`s promise and mankind overcome hunger, plaque, famine and war. However, there is a clause in the contract: if you manage to find meaning in humanism without gods that is not considered a breach. Humanism religion was invented in the last few centuries which exchanged the roles: not the world gives meaning to humans, but humans can give meaning to the world. Some part of the modern world does not necessary looses faith in gods but gains faith in humanity. Even Christians argue against homosexuality with the argument that it hurts their feelings, not gods feelings. Democracy is also a humanistic act, a few hundred years ago it would have looked foolish to give decision rights to people. Now the customer is the ultimate decision maker on if a product or a piece of art is good or not. The highest aim of a humanist life is to fully develop ones knowledge through a large variety of experiences, from full ignorance to enlightenment. Wilhelm von Humbolt, one of the architects of the modern education system: "the aim of existence is the destillation of the widest possible experiences of life into wisdom". These days stories, films, art shifts its focus from great hero, god like figures to the drama, feelings, experiences and growth of an average person, soldier, etc. Humanism branches: liberalism (individual focused), socialist (including communism), evolutionary (embracing natural selection and competition, including nationalism). The Word Wars were about this debate. Liberal democracies around the globe got outnumbered by socialists around the cold war period and the nuclear weapons were the main reason they survived. Socialism was one of the first techno-religions, and its success was based on the deep understanding of the era and that it could give relevant answers to the problems of the era (e.g. new production methods). Interestingly socialist countries collapsed around the 1980ties and they were replaced by liberal ones. The reason was similar, liberalism was able to adopt more to new technologies whereas socialists embraced ideas from the steam engine age. Science in the 21st century undermines liberal values because humans are better understood with all deterministic and random factors, the myth of free will and individual desires are destroyed. Robo-rats are rats with brain implants that stimulate the reward system: they are controlled by their free	Brilliant book from a history professor on how advancement of technologies, especially in data sciences and artificial intelligence, will reshape civilisation, culture, religions, ethics, sociology, philosophy, etc. Very readable, tons of interesting ideas presented in a very engaging way.	finished	*****

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Life 3.0: Being Human in the Age of Artificial Intelligence	Max Tegmark	Life = a process than retain its complexity and replicate. 1.0 = life form that does not evolve its hardware or software (one cell). 2.0 = life that designs its own software (organisms with brain). 3.0 = life that designs its own software and hardware (primarily AI, but humans are also 2.1 with healthcare). 13,9B years made dumb lifeless matter intelligent! Life is a process to increase entropy more efficiently by decreasing entropy (creating order) in a certain segment of the space. Moravec Paradox = low level sensomotoric tasks feel easy but they are computationally extremely difficult, a quarter of our whole brain is a specialised hardware for that. The landscape of computationally intensive problems is slowly "flooded" by AI, first jut the valleys like calculators, but slowly elevating, and in 50 years every human skill will be reached. Auto associative memory systems, like the brain, recalls memories by association, and not by its location as computer RAMs. Intuition and creativity seem to be human traits but deep learning, e.g. Alpha Go, demonstrate exactly that. An intelligent system is not necessary loyal to its goal, e.g. how humans already have different goal from their DNA and taking contraceptive pills instead of replicating. Goal alignment problem: how does an AI learn, adopt, and retain the goals we give him? Collaborating entities often need to give up some power to a hierarchy to enforce laws, e.g. immune system, but the cost-benefit need to in equilibrium. Technologies give the ability to to coordinate from from increasingly larger distances, that is how new hierarchical levels are made. Globalisation is just the newest level. Working for a human or AI driven corporation is not that different. Technology increases gap between poor and rich. AI driven wars might cost less human lives but they will also make it easier for everyone to start a war. Orthogonality thesis = goals of a system are independent of its intelligence level. E.g. a Pi calculating super intelligent AI would turn the whole universe into a supercomputer. Consciousness = subjective experience. Karl Popper: "If it is not falsifiable then it is not scientific.", this is the inherent testability of any scientific hypothesis. Humans might turn into "homo sentinents" because we will not be the smartest anymore, but the ones that have subjective experience.	The book was written by a former physics professor, turned into one of the key figures of AI research. The book tries to collect all the possible scenarios related to Artificial Intelligence: positive and negative outcomes, capabilities, dangers, timeframes on millions of years. The book is often more like a science-fiction but very engaging and still scientifically sound.	finsihed	***
Wired for Love: How Understanding Your Partner's Brain and Attachment Style Can Help You Defuse Conflict and Build a Secure Relationship	Stan Tatkin	Relationship paradigms (based on Helen Fisher): 1, Prehistoric (earlier than 11k years) the bond was based on the ethics of sharing, that served mutual interest (gathering and children raising / hunting and protecting), the bonds were not very durable or intimate, probably only for a few years; 2, agricultural revolution (around 11k years ago when cities, property ownership and economics emerged), marriage become an important part of social and economic structures, arranged marriage ("social marriage") was born: nothing to do the with love, only with social status, arranged marriages were enforced, no empathy; 3, 18th century, democratic institutions, everybody was entitled to have the freedom to get married of her choice, romantic love increased in significance ("psychological marriage"), but it was not really known before Freud (end of the 19th century) how our unconscious self plays more role here than our rational preference, we tend to choose a partner that resembles our caretakers (parents) and we present them our unmeet needs from childhood. Divorce got accepted, marriage counselling also appeared. Marriage counselling paradigms: 0, Originally by parents, religious leaders at arranged marriages: advice, mediation, etc. 1, Professional counselling: two independent individuals, focus on conflict resolution, negotiation, or healing individuals by psychotherapy in more sever cases. This is not very successful from the relationship perspective, counselling helps about 30%, divorce rate has been stable (about 50%) for the past 60 years. Paradigm: "If your needs are not satisfied in the relationship then you are married to the wrong person. Your marriage is about you and your needs." 4, A NEW marital and counselling narrative emerged the late 20st century, that is more relationship centric ("conscious partnership"): humans are born relation dependent, there are no individuals, only relationships, commitments to the relationship rather than to the self, the relationship-needs should be always primary and individual needs secondary which produces the paradoxical effect of having individual needs met too. Chapters: 1, Couple Bubble: "free lunch" that would not work with anyone else, relationship comes first, not individuals. More often self-trust and self-belief need to come first from others. Most often attractive traits come with ambivalent downsides, we cannot only accept the good side. 2, Warring/Loving brain: quick primitives to sense and fight danger (Amygdala, Hypothalamus, Adrenal gland, Dumb vagus, etc.); slow ambassadors, the rational and social functions (Smart vagus, Hippocampus, Insula, Orbital-frontal cortex, etc.). What triggers your primitives? 3, Know your partner: attachment theory (Secure: anchor, Insecure: island and wave). Insecure pattern develops if primary caregiver value self preservation, beauty, youth, loyalty, performance, money, loyalty, privacy, self-sufficiency etc. over relationship. 4, Become experts on One other: partner should know you and the tools to you better than yourself, even accepting and handling imperfections. Partners as regulators to each other. Understand each others 3-4 most important vulnerabilities / fears (and source of happiness, uplifts), probably the root causes of most issues, and the ways how to sooth. 5, Morning and Bedtime rituals: go to bed or launch together, partners should be their best anti depressant and anti-anxiety agents... 6, Be Go-to-People for each other. Two brains are better than one. Map your go-to people. 7, How to include outsiders in the relationship: objects, family members, business partners, hobbies, etc. Remind partner that she is the #1. Don`t shy away of thirds, find healthy ways to include them. 8, Fighting well, do not avoid arguments, use friendliness flag, stay in the play-zone, only win-win acceptable, look at each other during arguments and maintain eye contact, avoid mails, etc. 9, Practise eye contact a lot... 10, Reduce allostatic load with relationship..	Awesome book, science based life and mind hacks for better relationships. Apply practical fixes and principles to everything from your mindset, approach, rituals, sleep, etc. I especially liked the positive tone of the book, it makes me think relationships are not even difficult.	finished	***
When Breath Becomes Air	Paul Kalanithi	Brain diseases compared to others have an additional strangeness of the esoteric. When a doctor faces his own cancerous condition the investigation becomes psychologically impossible, someone needs to take over this responsibility. The paradox with science is that although it is the most useful way to organise reproducible data and describe the world, it is just a manufactured objectivity and it is inapplicable to the most central subjective aspects of human live: hope, fear, love, hate, beauty, envy, honour, weakness, striving, suffering, virtue. "The is lived in the first 20 years, the rest is just reflection" - Graham Greene	The book covers the last thoughts of a 36 years old top neurosurgeon who becomes a terminally ill cancer patient. The author was originally a Master of Arts in English Literature before he has changed career path to become a medical doctor, but has never had the time to really focus on writing except for his last months. Deeply humane thoughts on life, death, purpose, meaning of life, medicine, family, love, relationships, self reflection, etc.	finished	****

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Waking Up: A Guide to Spirituality Without Religion	Sam Harris	Given the neuroimaging technologies we no longer lack the tools to investigate spiritual experiences with scientific methods, as opposed to incompatible religious doctrines. Is there a form of happiness that does not depend on repetition of joy and avoiding pain? Most people say no but certain people come to other conclusions and start religious or spiritual practises, or go to solitary confinement. Buddhism in contrast to Christianity, Islam, Judaism has a comprehensive literature about the nature of mind, with rational practises, not a faith based religion. It`s central teachings are entirely empirical. We are all prisoners of our thoughts. Three typical strategies to deal with death: completely ignore it and thrive for wordy success and pleasure; believe in life after death based on a religion, or enlightenment. The reality of conscious experiences is the only thing in this universe that cannot be an illusion. If two different images are shown to the two eyes, we do not see them both blended, but the conscious experience is a transition back and forth every few seconds. This conscious experience is measurable in the brain. What is divided/split brain related to consciousness? Inner conflicts, surprises are entirely possible after surgery, two hands can draw different things, it seems that both brain sides can be conscious separately. Where is soul? What if the left hemisphere ask the right to be removed? Probably our brain contains a lot of competing thoughts and personalities. We feel we only have ethical implications towards creatures with some form of consciousness. Human mind is capable of of wonderful things but it is not in our powers to stop thinking even for a very short period. Even with a lot of practise and meditation it is only possible to recognise thoughts as transitory experiences and distinguish them from yourself. Movies/photos give the experience to be able observe others, have face to face encounters without them seeing us, a bit like transcendental voyeurism. Consciousness seems to be only independent on the brain structure, however, interestingly experiences are heavily culture dependent, no single feature is common around e.g. near death experiences, etc. Shamanism and enlightened societies seem to be independent: e.g. while the Mayas and Aztecs extensively used psychedelics they were also enthusiastic practitioners of human sacrifices.	The author is one of the 4 famous representatives of the new atheism ("Four Horsemen of the Non-Apocalyps: Richard Dawkins, Christopher Hitchens, Daniel Dennett, and Sam Harris."). What does science and experience say about the big spiritual questions without esoteric mysticism? What is the self? What is consciousness? Memories? Experiences? Time? What is self reflection? How do we relate to our bodies? What is meditation? Great book on huge questions, opened a new door for me wanting to explore more. The book is really dense, lots of unusually formed logical questions.	finshed	****
The Power of Habit: Why We Do What We Do in Life and Business	Charles Duhigg	Basal ganglia kicks in automation of the habit loop = Cue -> Trigger to tells the brain to go automatic, and which habit to use. (Cues fall into one of five categories: Location, Time, Emotional state, Other people, The immediately preceding action.) Routine -> physical, mental emotional. Reward -> Worth remembering for the future? Loop gets more automatic, then Cue and Reward merge, and an automatic carving raises for the routine after the cue. Habits can be ignored, changed, replaced. Changing/Replacing (same cue, same reward) has much higher probability, Even with several brain damage and memory loss it is possible to form new habits through the habit loop if the basal ganglia is ok. Smoking because of stimulation from nicotine or just because of a cue? Identifying the cues and changing routine leads to much higher success rate in quitting. In some cases believing in being able to change the habit is a key factor. In team sports it is often the best strategy to make team formations into a habit, that is the fastest way to execute. Keystone habits implanted into organisational cultures can incredible powers when spread through the whole company. How to identify keystone habits? Searching for characteristics that produces small wins, those form contagious habits (e.g. continuous improvement, risk assessment). Great leaders really create organisational habits, often using the opportunity after crises to reformulate habits. Measurable self discipline predicts better any academic performance than IQ. It was also shown that willpower is a learnable skill like maths. Willpower can be exhausted but it can also be just trained like a muscle. Clinical studies show that willpower muscles get tired much slower if they have decision power and act for a purpose. However, people sometimes seem to deliver without huge efforts or willpower, usually they just formed good habits, that is the easiest. New (food eating) habits can also be formed easier if new (food, the) cue looks familiar. A movement often can only become self propelling if a 3 part social process is right: habits shows up between close social ties, friends, aquentencies; growths through the community weak ties between clans and neighbourhoods; and endures because leaders give further new habits with a fresh a sense identity and feeling of ownership. Sleep terrors show similar neurological patterns to habits, although they are the most primal kinds, similar to walking, breathing etc. They can occur without input from higher regions of the brain, but because the prefrontal cortex sleeps there is no way to override. Even people killing family members on sleep terror episodes were found not guilty in the eyes of the law. Pathological gamblers anticipate near misses like wins, normal people feel a near miss like loss. There are real neurological differences, although not clear if they are born like that or their brains are trained to that. Slot machines, scratch tickets are programmed to deliver near misses. Lawsuits were filed agains pharmaceutical companies claiming that medications effect that neurochemistry and habit loop, and patient cannot withstand gambling, and patients won trials. Habit reshaping framework: identify the routine, experiment with rewards, isolate the cue, have a plan. Experiment with rewards: after each activity write down the first three things that comes to your mind, continue working then 15 mins later check if you still feel the original urge. You can isolate what you are actually craving for. Isolate the cue, typically in these categories: location, time, emotional state, other people, immediately preceding action: try to write down one word for each of these categories every time when the carving kicks in. Have a plan: set the alarm etc. to even avoid to feel the original craving.	Very readable, with a lot of loosely related stories, and the last chapter is finally informative and very practical, the essence of the whole book. The book covers an important and complex topic, with a seemingly great approach (by combining academic research with practical guidance), but it is a bit of a missed opportunity. Too many lengthy stories, not too many evidence based insights, lack of academic rigour, disregarding related fields (human ethology, evolutionary psychology, etc.). Some overlap with the "Thinking fast and slow book", but that covers the topic better.	finished	***

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The Emperor of All Maladies: A Biography of Cancer	Siddhartha Mukherjee	Science begins with counting, if cancer wants to be a rigorous science it needs to be measured. As long as tumor size could not be measured, therapy effectiveness could not be either earlier. However, leukemic cells in blood could be counted under a microscope. This cancer model would allow researchers to draw conclusions on potency of compounds or on other cancer types - argued Sydney Farber in 1940`s. The 50 year before 1950 with two world-wars (hygiene vaccines, antibiotics and other drugs) lead to more significant advancement of post war medicine then multiple centuries before: increased life expectancy in the US from 47 to 68, half of the drugs used every day were not known a decade earlier. In the 1950`s 1k new hospital opened, patient numbers doubled, cure become the default expectation. 1937 - US President Roosevelt Signed the National Cancer Institute (NCI) act, an NIH organisation organising research ant treatment. Lack of folate in food (vitamin like substance needed for DNA) led to abnormal blood. Sydney Farber tried to heal leukemia with folate but found that folic acid instead of stopping leukemia proliferation it accelerated it. So what about anti-folic acid? This lead to the discovery of the first anti-cancer medicine in 1947 (Aminopterin), unfortunately remission was always temporary. First description of cancer: about 27th century BC Egyptian physician and polyhistor, Imhotep, wrote a medical book on 48 medical cases. He described first breast cancer as a distinct disease, added diagnosis, but no possible treatment, not even palliative. References to cancer are absent in medical history or religious texts (as opposed to other ancient diseases like tuberculosis, smallpox, etc.). The main reasons are: 1, cancer is heavily age related, people did not live long enough, longevity revealed it; 2, advancements in precise diagnostics. Before 1940s cancer was not among the top 6 death causes. Hippocrates named tumors in 400BC the carcinos (or crab), as he saw the swollen blood vessels around the tumor. Oncos was also used later by greeks (in greek mass, load or) burden that the body needs to carry. Greeks thought too much black-bile (Humorism, 4 major body fluid theory) causes it. The theory was only dropped around the 18th century when western medicine failed to confirm it in any form! Surgery and especially cancer surgery mad a huge leap between 1846-1867 because of two advancements: surgery in deep sleep (anesthesia with ether, dissociation pain from surgery); and antiseptic surgery (Pasteur`s food sterilisation practises brought to surgery with carbolic acid). Jospeh Lister, a british surgeon used both to perform a breast cancer surgery on his sister on their dining table in 1869, and she survived... William Halsted, pioneer of ultra-radical cancer surgeries (mastectomy), around the prime of his career in 1884 started to use cocaine as an anesthetic, but while he started to experiment with it on himself in intravenous applications he become stongly addicted and treated with morphine. His very disciplined and scheduled dosing regimen lead to remarkable progress with his methods but also more absurd and awkward strategies and antisocial life. In 1902 Marie Curie purified Radium, which revealed two properties of X-rays: it could not only carry radiant energy through human tissues as other known radiant materials but also deposit energy deep inside tissues: photos were possible, but also a few milligrams could burned through body. Specific affinity of molecules (the invention of which worth Nobel prize for Paul Ehrlich in 1908) made antibiotics possible agains bacteria, however cancer cells are human cells, thus were thought to be untreatable with drugs. Nitrogen mustard was invented in the textile industry, was later used as a war gas and used first in 1917, but the known long term effects were overlooked in the middle war: it killed bone marrow, it had specific affinity! It later become one of the first drugs used in medical oncology... From the 1940`s Sydney Farber (pioneer of medical oncology) and Mary Lasker (health activist, philanthropist, lobbyist) set up a synergistic partnership ("Laskerites"), a lobby group that has driven cancer research politics and fundings for the following 4 decades in the US.  In the 1960`s Howard Skipper experimenting with mice had two main findings on chemotherapy: 1, it always kills fix percentage of tumor cels, same percentage in every round, 2, combining different drugs with different mechanisms decreases the chances of resistance. This lead to more and more radical versions of combination chemotherapy (look Halsted radical mastectomy earlier...), but pioneers like Freireich and Frei at NCI refining the regimen made Acute lymphoblastic leukemia curable with chemo at the first time in history in the 60`s Voltaire: "Doctors are men who prescribe medicines of which they know little, to cure diseases of which they know less in human beings of whom they know nothing." The early 1900s the "somatic mutation hypothesis" of cancer was accepted: environmental carcinogens (e.g. Chimney sweep's cancer), alter the cell in a fundamental way and transforms it to cancer. However, in 1911 Peyton Rous discovered first time that some mysterious particles from cancer cells can infect other cells, and he later proved that the transmission was caused a virus (Rous sarcoma virus, that was worth Nobel prize much later in 1966). This lead to a new wave of research for cancer causing viruses, and histeria spread about cancer being infectious, but except for a few cases (EBV, HPV, etc.) the "cancer virus theory" was a failure after 3 decades of research. December 1971 Nixon signed signed the National Cancer Act, pushed by Mary Lasker, which poured billions of dollars into cancer research in the coming years lead by NCI. The aim was to achieve a similar breakthrough as moon landing, but many thought this was a premature as science did not understand even basic principles behind cancer. In the 60s-70s medicine was still too much based on authority and not based on evidence or statistics. Bernard Fisher: "In God we trust. All others must have data.", and he started a 10 year study to compare radical mastectomy vs simple mastectomy vs radiation + mastectomy. In 1981 results were published, and proved to be identical (survival, recurrence or mortality) but the first group has payed a high price in morbidity. About 500k women underwent radical mastectomy unnecessarily though almost 100 years. In 1948 the first large scale survey and study on lung cancer did not even suspect smoking to be a root cause, because everyone smoked. The early results were so strong that researchers on the study immediately stoped smoking, but results were not conclusive enough for the public. A committee of 10 prominent scientists (5 smoker / 5 non smokers), was asked to assess all the evidences, a study reviewed over 1M cases, thousands of studies, etc. One of them was William Cochran who proposed the mathematical concept of epidemiology "metastudies" the first time. The "Surgeon General's report on smoking and health" was published 1963, it was one of the strongest correlations ever found, and is still a methodological blueprint in epidemiology. The dose limit of a chemotherapeutic agent was mostly defined by the most sensitive organ to that, mostly bone marrow, sometimes kidney or liver. As transplantations in the late 1960`s become possible (autologous, back into the same patient, or allogeneic into other patient) that pushed the limit further and made chemotherapeutic megadoses possible. It not just become possible but the mainstream and a great business, however, when in the 90`s proper randomized trials were carrier out it was proven that it does not have benefits (see Halsted radical surgery...). Since 1911 it has been known that the Rous sarcoma virus (RSV) causes cancer in chicken. In 1977 Michael Bishop and Harold Varmus (got Nobel prize later in 1979) showed that activated SRC gene in the virus, that turns the cell into a multiplying machine, can be found in deactivated form in the genom of many organisations (proto-oncogene). This has revealed an entirely new hypothesis: the reto-virus does not cause cancer by itself, but probably the retro-virus picked up the SRC gene from a mutated cancer cell and carried in the viral genom, then adds it again to other cells. The virus, the parasite, has been parasitized by a parasite, the cancer gene! Amazing progress of science, hypotheses evolving though a century. In 1982 the first human oncogenge, RAS gene family was discovered, and it was proven than "cancer is in our genes". In 1985 while analysing the rare Retinoblastoma and the RB gene the tumor-supressor genes (anti-oncogenes) were discovered, and "two-hit hypothesis" was published.In 2000 Douglas Hanahan and Robert Weinberg published the "The Hallmarks of Cancer" paper where they fist time described the 6 common traits of all cancer types: 1, self-sufficiency in growth signals; 2 insensitivity to anti-growth signals; 3 evading apoptosis; 4 limitless replicative potential; 5 sustained angiogenesis; 6 issue invasion and metastasis. This made cancer treatment the first time a rational science, from the 90`s more and more targeted therapies are available. For 2005 death rates for nearly every major form of cancer has dropped for 15 straight years, about 1% per year. Chronic myelogenous leukemia (CML) was a rare and deadly form of cancer, few thousand patients were diagnosed every year. However, with Gleevec/Imatinib it is possible to stay alive on average of 30 years, 100ks of patients will live with CML on targeted therapy soon. A once rare disease will become a relatively common one, the perfect inversion of cancers medicine`s goal: the drug increases prevalence of cancer.In Framingham, MA, US a study began in 1948 (Framingham Heart Study) where all possible medical data was collected about ~5000 ppl, and the longitudinal study follows now the third generation of the population, it is still ongoing. This cohort was the foundation of many epidemiological observations. In 2008 even social networks were analyzed related to medical issues: social networks predict better smoking and others habits, thus cancer prevalence too than anything else. This should also be among the most important cancer prevention strategies. In 2005 Cancer Genome Atlas project started: discovering every gene mutation in any common form of cancer. This needs the sequencing capacity of about 10k Human Genome Projects. A group lead by Bert Vogelstein started studying the Cancer Genome Landscape: about 40-80 genes are typically mutated in each cancer type (few exceptions: e.g. ALL 5-10 genes, maybe that is why it is susceptible to drugs and more curable). Mutations are very different in every patients. There are passenger mutations, they are passive, whereas driver mutations are active and play a role, they hit tumor supressors and oncogenes. Driver mutations can be organised by pathways. Typically 12-15 pathways are mutated in each tumor type. Cancer might represent the inherent outer limit to our development as an organism. Thus, a more	Pulitzer Prize-winning masterpiece. The book is long but fabulously combines medical, spiritual, historical non-fiction knowledge with the style of a psychodrama. Everything you wanted to know about cancer in a style of a detective story: history, medical paradigms, therapies, biology, classification, research and healthcare politics, important names, smoking, molecular biology, psychology, sociology, futurology etc. And I was touched more by the individual lives and stories than by any other book that I have read recently.	finished	*****

Book Title (year of reading)	Author	Learnings / my notes	Comment	Status (reading, finished, gave up, planning)	Would I recommend it? (* = bad, don`t recommend ** = readable, don`t recommend *** = interesting / good, **** = must read / great ***** = epiphany / masterpiece)
48 Laws of Power	Robert Greene	LAW 1) Never outshine the master (p1-7)LAW 2) Never put too much trust in friends, learn how to use enemies (p8-15) LAW 3) Conceal your intentions (p16-30) LAW 4) Always say less than necessary (p31-36) LAW 5) So much depends on reputation --- guard it with your life! (p37-43) LAW 6) Court attention at all cost (p44-55) LAW 7) Get others to do the work for you, but always take the credit! (p56-61) LAW 8) Make other people come to you --- use bait if necessary! (p62-68) LAW 9) Win through your actions, never through argument (p69-75) LAW 10) Infection --- avoid the unhappy and unlucky (p76-81) LAW 11) Learn to keep people dependent on you (p82-88) LAW 12) Use selective honesty and generosity to disarm your victim (p89-94) LAW 13) When asking for help, appeal to people's self-interest, never to their mercy or gratitude (p95-100) LAW 14) Pose as a friend, work as a spy (p101-106) LAW 15) Crush your enemy totally! (p107-114) LAW 16) Use absence to increase respect and honor (p115-122) LAW 17) Keep others in suspended terror --- cultivate an air of unpredictability! (p123-129) LAW 18) Do not build fortresses to protect yourself --- isolation is dangerous! (p130-136) LAW 19) Know who you are dealing with --- do not offend the wrong person (p137-144) LAW 20) Do not commit to anyone (p145-155) LAW 21) Play a sucker to catch a sucker --- seem dumber than your mark (p156-162) LAW 22) Use the surrender tactic --- transform weakness into power! (p163-170) LAW 23) Concentrate your forces (p171-177) LAW 24) Play the perfect courtier (p178-190) LAW 25) Re-create your life! (p191-199) LAW 26) Keep your hands clean (p200-214) LAW 27) Play on people's need to believe to create a cultlike following (p215-226) LAW 28) Enter action with boldness (p227-235) LAW 29) Plan all the way to the end (p236-244) LAW 30) Make your accomplishments seem effortless (p245-253) LAW 31) Control the options --- get others to play with the cards you deal (p254-262) LAW 32) Play to people's fantasies (p263-270) LAW 33) Discover each employee's thumbscrew! (p271-281) LAW 34) Be royal in your own fashion --- act like a king or queen to be treated like one! (p252-290) LAW 35) Master the art of timing (p291-299) LAW 36) Disdain things you cannot have --- ignoring them is the best revenge! (p300-308) LAW 37) Create compelling spectacles (p309-316) LAW 38) Think as you like but behave like others (p317-324) LAW 39) Stir up waters to catch fish! (p325-332) LAW 40) Despise the free lunch (p333-346) LAW 41) Avoid stepping into a great man's shoes (p347-357) LAW 42) Strike the shephere and the sheep will scatter (p358-366) LAW 43) Work on the hearts and minds of others! (p367-375) LAW 44) Disarm and infuriate with the "mirror effect" (p376-391) LAW 45) Preach the need for change, but never reform too much at once! (p392-399) LAW 46) Never appear too perfect! --- Only gods and the dead can seem perfect with impunity! (p400-409) LAW 47) Do not go past the mark you aimed for --- in victory, learn when to stop! (p410-418) LAW 48) Assume formlessness! (p419-430)	Patterns of power games, to make it easier to recognise, avoid, or play. Good, but very long because 80% of the book is historical fiction, short, independent stories to illustrate the point. The "power" version of the classic book "Games people play" without the scientific approach.	finished	***
Avoidant: How to Love (or Leave) a Dismissive Partner	Jeb Kinnison	The Anxious type asks for reassurance too often. If the Anxious does not get a response then asks increasingly more often. That recalls avoidant patters in anyone. Anxious can push Secures to be Avoidants, and similarly Avoidants can push Secures to be Anxious. If partners (homo or hetero, married or not) call for intimacy or for connecting (even just by saying: "look, such a nice bird!") the response pattern can predict with 90% probability the outcome of the relationship. In a study couples who had divorced after 6 years responded to bidding interactions 33%, while couples who where still together after 6 years responded to these bids 87% of the times. There are two ways to think about kindness. With a fixed trait mindset or with a growth mindset (look for the book "Mindset"). Masters tend to think about kindness as a muscle, it needs to be continuously trained. Similarly in relationships: studies have shown that people who believe in relationships as a perfect unity have worse relationships than the ones who think about relationships as a journey of growing and working together. About 50% of the population is Secure, but their ratio gets lower in ageing dating pools. Anxious preoccupied type is about 20% of the population. Their early attachment needs were not or were inconsistently satisfied. They crave intimacy but doubtful about their own worth, they can feel needy or clingy. Their childhood memories still hurt and are still alive, but not well integrated into their adult thinking. Typically they have memories about intense efforts to please their parents, sometimes role reversals with the parents. In their adulthood they often keep their attachment figures close with making them feel gilt and blame. Lowest average of income at workplace. Difficult for them to focus on anything else than relationships, even at work. They need interactions everywhere. Their feelings are strong and can discuss them when calm, but their feelings are centered around their own needs for attention. They commonly blame others because others not understanding their needs, but they do not feel safe enough in a relationship to describe them openly. They want to merge with their partners so they are prone to codependence, a dysfunctional mutual dependence where neither of the partners grow further. Engaging more often in sexual relationships with former partners. There are two subtyope os Avoidants. All Avoidants distrust caregivers, but the "Fearful" Avoidants have not developed the high self-esteem as the "Dismissive" Avoidants to do have enough without attachments. The Fearful Avoidant is the Avoidant who has not given up. The Dismissive Avoidant completed a mental transformation to say they are good enough themselves and they do not need others, and "I am fine as I am". He does not have apparent reason to take part in an attachment signalling game with a partner. They value their independence. Often have a story about a previous relationship that was never fully realized, or ended when the partner left. Often embrace early hurts which built their characters. When their partner is away from home they take it as an opportunity to get more done. Seek less demanding partners for reciprocation, or partners who do not need to be asked for sex, intimacy, etc, like Anxious types. Workaholics. Prefer work alone. Incomes are as high as for Secures. Phenomenal explorers and individual contributors (e.g. science), not so good in teamwork. Can play roles well. Avoidants partners do not get and stay together because someone needs to start the attachment signalling cycle. The signs of need and vulnerability is threatening for them, both for themselves and for their partner. Hostile dismissive humor is the most characteristic. Avoidant like to bask in the glow of the superior performance even if that hurts the relationship and the partner`s self-worth. Denies the benefit of her partners successful performance. Narcissistic tendencies (narcism is an extreme form of avoidance). Take distant employment opportunities or often go on activities alone. Unconsciously they use deactivating strategies to avoid feeling attached. Look for opportunities to distance their partners, often because of trivial stylistic issues, but subconsciously they are just afraid of being dependent. Avoidants view romantics and sex different things, they tend to have shorter relationships. They look confident, dominant, but problematic and unprotective of their partners in relationships. Often use sex to maximize control over a partner. Often had more partners and therefore more experienced in sex. Secure-secures couples are the most common, Avoidant-Axious is the second most common. Four horseman of the apocalypse in a relationship: 1, overall criticism of the other`s character; 2, contempt, sarcasm, cynicism (only in toxic relationships); 3, defensiveness; 4, stonewalling (no verbal feedback, just leave the room). Consider how long would a friend stay that person would experience these? Regular relationship conflicts with anyone (partner, friend, family, etc.) increases the chances of death 2-3 times in the following 10 years than for the rest of the control population. These statistics are similar to e. g. obesity or smoking! Men`s health is more relationship dependent. When dating, do not lower your standard just set better ones. Try to ignore superficial values (attractiveness, wealth, height, etc.) that is in high demand and find undervalued assets ("moneyballing relationships"). E.g. there is no evidence that wealth or attractiveness lead to greater relationship satisfaction, however, "agreeableness" has a proven strong correlation to relationship success.	The book digs a bit deeper into the Avoidant topic of attachment theory, and it does that well. Sometimes a bit of horoscope, sometimes a lot of scientific evidence. Unfortunately not very positive, not from the avoidant`s perspective and does not give too many practical recommendations. Significant overlap with the "Attached" book of Levine and Heller and a bit less readable.	finished	***

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Tribes: We Need You to Lead Us	Seth Godin	Management: manipulating resources to get a know job done, faster cheaper. Managers make widgets. Leadership: creating change you believe in. Leaders create change. Telling people what to do vs inciting a movement. Movement happens when people talk, when peer support make people do what they have always knew was the right thing. Transforming group of people to a tribe: a shared interest transforming to a goal, and providing ways to communicate (lead to tribe, tribe to lead, member to member, member to outsider). -> Viral effect (virtuous cycle). Kevin Kelly: "One thousand true fans" concept. 1969 - Dr. Lurraence "Peter principle", paraphrased: people rise till they get too good in following, and forget to lead. 1, publish a manifesto, a mantra. 2, make it easy to connect with you, 3, make it easy for the members to connect, 4, realise that money is not the point, 5, track your progress transparently. The secret of leadership: do what you believe in, paint a picture of the future and go there, people will follow. This is when hope and optimism is matched. Managers are the pessimists and cynics, cos they have seen it before and believe they have done it as good as it is possible. Being charismatic does not make you a leader, being a leader makes you charismatic. Being charismatic is a choice and not a choice not a gift you are born with. Active listening is a very important leadership skill, maybe the most important one. It is difficult for a leader to do it right because it is easy to confuse it with being a follower or be too easy to influence. How to make a large impact with a movement: find leaders, heretics who do things differently, and amplify their work, help them find followers. Average people want to be sure they will get the credit for their ideas and work. Leaders do not care. Leaders want others to take credit. Credit is not the point. The change is to point. People always believe their own stories the most, they often believe their friends, etc. Leaders give stories that people can tell themselves.	An interesting topic, unfortunately the book is just a random brain-dump from an experienced leader. Not too many new insights, not too organised, no scientific or pragmatic approach, just a quick motivational book focusing on visionary leadership. Fortunately very short. The book reminds me of the "The War of Art".	finished	**
The Death of Cancer: After Fifty Years on the Front Lines of Medicine, a Pioneering Oncologist Reveals Why the War on Cancer Is Winnable--and How We Can Get There	Vincent T. DeVita Jr. MD, Elizabeth DeVita-Raeburn	There are in vivo mouse models (L1210 leukemic mouse model) where the death is comes exactly after X days (9 for L1210) without treatment. Was very effective for testing therapies. Combination (chemo)therapy was never really encouraged or accepted, but later it turned out it is the only effective option. "We have met the enemy and he is us." (19th century battlefield quote...) For around 1970 2/3 of Hodgkins was curable with chemo. (Androgen) hormone therapy is often a viable option. First computerized clinical trial register for cancer in 1982 (Physician Data Query). First set of laws specific to drugs in 1906; Food, Drug and Insecticide Administration in 1926. "Frances Kelsey award" for drug safety by FDA (stopping harmful drugs to go to the market), but there is not opposite award, leads to a controversial tendency with cancer drugs. Randomised trials in cancer giving active and placebo is unethical, but sometimes required by regulators. Pretreated cancer patients react much worse to anything, their cancer cells are smarter. Norton-Simon effect: after therapy smaller cancer cell populations grow back faster then remaining large populations! Counterintuitive! (E.g. 5 years later patients will have same numbers). Three paradigm shifts in cancer therapy for the past 50 years: 1, combination chemotherapy: decline of leukemia, lymphoma; 2, therapy targeting pathways: lung cancer, melanoma; 3, immunotherapy: melanoma. 2010, Hanahan and Weinberg, "The Hallmarks of Cancer", most cited paper in Cell journal ever. The Hallmarks: 1, Self-sufficiency in growth signals; 2, Insensitivity to anti-growth signals; 3, Evading programmed cell death; 4, Limitless replicative potential; 5, Developing blood vessels; 6, Tissue invasion and metastasis. Hanahan added 4 others in 2010 in a new paper: Deregulated metabolism, Evading the immune system, Genome instability, Inflammation. Aerob (Oxidative phosphorylation) vs. Anaerob (glycolysis) metabolism: cancer cells can do both, and prefer anaerob. Cancer "teratoma": can develop different tissue or organ components (e.g. hair). Tumor promoting Inflammation: inflammation plays an important role in cancer development. (Smoking, Alcohol, etc?!) A lower dose chemo might leads to complete remission too but the long term survival rate is different. Tumors have different patterns of metastasis, and communication happens between the tumor and the primary site of metastasis, the organ prepares a pre-metastatic site. It is possible to put cancer cells into a dormant state by deactivating a hallmark. This might lead to chronic therapies. Immune checkpoint blockers: 2 approved (Keytruda, Opdivo), 1 on the way, and 20 in development in 2015. The problem is that we know the safety profiles but they cannot be used in different cancer types.	Memoir of one of the highest profile cancer researches who filled all the leadership roles of the domain, like head of US National Cancer Institute, etc. An important tabu topic that almost everyone needs to face with at one point in life. First half is shocking to read even for the ones trained in medicine, the second half is more about politics where the author throws all of his peers under the bus.	finished	***

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Attached: The New Science of Adult Attachment	Amir Levine, Rachel Heller	Dependency paradox: the more emotional needs are met in a relationship, the more the attention turns outwards. Both in adult relationships and babies. The avoidant/secure/anxious attachment styles model comes from the "strange situation test" of 9-18 month old babies, based on their behaviour patterns when left alone and mommy returns. Attachment theory in one sentence: If you want to take the route to independence and happiness, first find the right person to depend on, second, travel the road down with her. Once we become attached we become one physiological unit, our partner regulates blood pressure, hormone levels, etc. The need to share our life is part of our genetic makeup. How to decipher attachment styles? Rely on various signs in parallel: how she seeks intimacy and closeness, how preoccupied is she with relationships, reaction to effective communication, how sensitive is she for rejection, look for what she is not saying or doing. Anxious styles: Don`t let emotional unavailability turn you on. Pay attention to protest behaviours: any action that tries to reestablish contact and get attention (activating strategy). Happens even when he is not there anymore but you are unable to push him out of our mind.  Avoidant styles: Typical adventurer`s last note in a diary when dying alone in the middle of nowhere: "Happiness only real when shared." A survival advantage, but it cannot buy you love: in harsh conditions and extreme environment it was successful evolutionary tactic but not an advantage for the individual. Deactivating strategies: any psychological mechanism to suppress need for intimacy e.g. saying "not ready to commit" but staying together; finding small things you don`t like in your partner, remembering the One or keeping connections earlier partners, pulling away, not listening carefully to the partner, physical distance in bed or walking. A strong belief in self reliance can be rather a burden than an asset. Looking for the perfect One is one of the most powerful tools to create distance: first someone seems amazing but after suddenly experience the chilling effect e.g. start looking for small imperfections, a search for negativity to turn off attachment needs, then the partner protests, that reinforces, etc. Eight steps to stop pushing away love: 1, learn your deactivating strategies; 2, deemphasize self reliance and focus on mutual support, 3, find a secure partner, 4, be aware of your tendency to misinterpret behaviours, 5, gratitude list, 6, forget phantom X as a deactivation strategy, 7, forget about the One and make them the One, 8, adopt distraction strategy to spend more time together. Secure styles: Attachment styles are a function of life experiences, especially of our interaction with parents. Based on science, a secure style has higher chance to develop if the parents are responsive to the infant child`s needs, but there are lot of other factors, and there is also genetic predisposition. Game-playing is often a deal-breaker for secures, without ant negative feeling they just moves on. 30-25% of the population change attachment style in life, mainly because of a profound life experience that changes basic believes. Anxious-avoidant trap: mutually activating and deactivating attachment systems, hard to move because they are in a cycle of exacerbating each other`s insecurities. Signs: 1, roller coster effect, 2, emotional counter-balancing act: avoidance feel powerful as long as their anxious feels incapable, 3, stable instability: chronic dissatisfaction of intimacy that both are comfortable with, 4, all fights are about the intimacy behind the scenes, 5, becoming the enemy when getting into the inner circle of the avoidant, 6, experiencing the trap: too connected to leave. Usually does not work, if yes, usually the anxious needs to adapt... While recalling a certain memory or scene we also disrupt and alter it forever, so our current experiences reshape our past ones. What we recall today is a function of the memory and of our later experiences. That is one of the tricks to rework our attachment models: recall certain memories, patterns, models and rethink it with a more secure point of view, identify activation/deactivation patterns, etc. Life in inner circle, the secure style: treating the other like royalty. If you are the enemy, let it go. Loosing an attachment figure look like physical pain under MRI, and getting back that figure can resolve it in a second. Anxious types let go even harder. Effective communication is key for avoidant or anxious types to find compromises. 73% are willing to sacrifice their major life goals for a perfect relationship.	This has changed the way how I view my attachment instincts. It is especially useful for adults who still have not been able to figure out relationships. Extremely readable, no bullshit, information-dense, it made me understand my toxic behaviour patterns and blind spots. More of a relationship self-help book but rooted and explained in the scientific context of attachment theory. I would make this mandatory for everyone in high school.	finished	*****
2016		Keywords: relationships, leadership in large organisations			
Men Are from Mars, Women Are from Venus: The Classic Guide to Understanding the Opposite Sex	John Gray	Men instinctively offer solutions when women talk about problems, as a way of showing love. When women just keep talking about problems men feel increasingly useless. Women just look for empathy and interest, that is not an invitation to offer a solution, that can even feel invalidating her problems. Unsolicited advice from women can often feel critical and unloving, men continuously need to prove that they can get things done and worth women`s trust. Offering help to a men if he does not ask is rude. After a stressful day a men tries to find relieve by forgetting them and doing something totally different, whereas a women tends to talk about that. Men talk about problems when they are blaming someone or asking for advice, and they often assume the same from women. When a men is in love and mature he starts to care for someone else like he cares for himself, her partners fulfilment is like his own, self-gratification does not satisfy himself. However, women need to learn how to show trust and receive (they tend to over-give) and only then man can learn how to give and show they care. Women misinterpret men`s silence, they assume the worst, but men are just silent when they do not have answers. Men just tend to pull back their cave`s to think. Women do not understand this because it is just rude to abandon anyone who has problems. They both need to stop offering the care that they would expect. Men have intimacy cycles to pull away and come back. If he does not have a chance to feel the distance he will also not have a chance to experience his desire to be close. Women also have mood or self-esteem cycles and similarly problems do not need to be always solved by offering solutions, they need to hit bottom. These average out to 20-30 days and might have hormonal causes. Instincts to deal with problems with short term gains: fight (more men`s tool, offensive, blaming, etc.), flight (more men`s tool, passive aggressive, pulling away, etc.) fake (more women`s tool, pretends there is no problem, fooling ourselves, etc.), fold (more women`s tool, take the blame for everything). Men and women track gift points differently: men score few points for small gifts and many point for large gifts, whereas women score the same for everything. E.g. men tend to over-focus on huge goals like vacation, house, etc and neglect everyday gifts. Women do not even track scores until their love tank is full, they just give freely. Men track and stop giving when they are even. Men think that if a women gives than the score is uneven for him. Love letter technique: write a letter about your feelings about anger, sadness, fear, regret, love. Write a response letter, what you would want to hear from your partner to feel better - it will show how difficult would it be to deal with you for your partner. Show one or both if you want. Whenever we remain upset for more than 20 mins about something, it most often shows that the experience comes from us and not from the circumstance.	The best selling relationship self-help book of all time. Irritatingly simple language and lessons. Male chauvinism, from an era before gender equality. Few very important topics but endless elaboration.	finished	**

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The War of Art: Break Through the Blocks and Win Your Inner Creative Battles	Steven Pressfield	Resistance... is everywhere, invisibleIs, can take any form, but it is the enemy within. Self doubt and fear is good! An indicator, it tells us what we have to do! Fear is proportional to resistance. We are not our job descriptions! The amateur over-invests in his job and over-terrified of its failure. Resistance loves this! A professional cannot let himself take humiliation personally! It is the external reflection of internal resistance. Jung: Ego (drives everyday life, solid principles and beliefs like no god exists, resistance lives here), it is part of the bigger Self (feelings like time and space are illusions, supreme emotion is love, dreams and intuition). The moment when we realise we will die our consciousness shifts from ego to the self, this is entirely new view. Can our un-lived life take its vengeance in the form of a disease? Can we cure it by living that life? Connection to territory vs Rank in a hierarchy: these are the two ways how humans and animals define themselves, and achieve psychological security. Hierarchy seems to be a default from early childhood, we only start to exploring territorial orientation later. Hierarchical does not work in large systems of over few 100 or 1000 entities, like a city, a company, etc. Hierarchy is fatal for artists, professionals. What is your mindset: if you would be the last person on earth, would you still do your job? A territory sustains us without external input, it gives back exactly what you put in.	An artist`s inner battle who reinvents stoicism on the way. The presentation is artistic itself, gives an experience, hard to give back specific learnings.	finished	**
Platform Revolution: How Networked Markets Are Transforming the Economy	Geoffrey G. Parker	Supply economies of scale: production of large quantities and reducing unit cost VS. Demand economies of scale: tech improvements on the demand side, demand aggregation through network effects, value growths non linearly with the size. Good governance matters: 1% drop in corruption and misuse of public money is associated with 1,7% rise in GDP. Fast open feedback on good behaviors but delayed opaque application of laws on misbehaviors otherwise it is easy to learn and avoid laws. Platform business metrics: rate of interaction success VS pipeline business core metric: process efficiency of the value flow. Social interaction distance between producers and consumers/customers can be an important metric in any kind of business, even manufacturing. Decades to overtake leaders in traditional industries but years with platforms. Ownership of infrastructure is not necessarily a competitive advantage. Banning flash by apple: avoid app porting to other platforms and avoiding off platform interactions (flash in app purchases). Alibaba blocked Baido bots to index, to avoid advertisements to go off platform, and become the largest online ad business in China. Low number of successful unicorn startups in EU is because platforms cannot scale. Regulation 1.0: restrictions (information scarcity) VS Regulation 2.0: data driven accountability (government`s role is to provide transparency). Resource intensive industries (e.g. mining) are less information intensive, more difficult to platformize, but will transform. Healthcare (collecting doctors/patient, but sharing healthcare data is problematic, tech companies targeting this issue) and education (distributed university degrees...) are the next industries to be disrupted, "gatekeepers", but cannot hold back for long.	Focused pretty much on economic platforms and not IT platforms. Analyses platforms in every possible way. Important topics but a bit lost in details.	finished	***
The 5 Love Languages: The Secret to Love That Lasts	Gary D Chapman	Obsession is not love (2 years or less), that is a temporary "in love" experience, that is mating call... love is a conscious choice, an attitude with proper behavior. 5 Love languages: Gifts, Quality time, Words of affirmation, Acts of service, Physical touch. Babbling book (always talk) and dead see (listening) personality, go very well when dating, attract each other, but it is very hard on a long term. Quality activity: one of you wants, the other willing to do, both know why we are doing it. Concept of love and marriage transcends cultural barriers, giving is a universal pattern. Spender personality vs Saving personality when giving gifts: purchasing gift is an investment to fill the others love tank who will reciprocate. Physical presence in critical times (death, hospitalisation) is the most powerful gift for someone whose love language is gifts, or missing it means the opposite. Make requests lists for each other, that forces us to think concretely. In times of crisis we hug each other with everyone, cos that is one of the strongest expressions of love. If you cannot find our your or your partner`s language think about the negative use: what neglect or act hurts the most? Your own language (what you expect) is most probably is what you most often do to express love. People almost never fall in and out of love the same day, deal with it.	A deeply christian marriage counselor, anthropologist, shares annoyingly simple truths and practises on long term relationships. However, if you are like me, you might discover that you have not even thought about them. I have just realised how little I know about relationships compared to some other topics bellow.	finished	****
DMT: The Spirit Molecule	Rick Strassman	State-specific memory: events experienced in an altered state of mind can only be recalled in the same state. It might be possible to chemically dissect mental functions into their basic physiologic components. Psychedelics exert their effect by a complex blending of three factors: Set - Setting - Drug. DMT is transferred by active transport through the blood brain barrier by precious energy. The pineal gland is the only singleton (unpaired) organ of the brain. The anatomical emergence of the pineal gland and reproductive organs in the embryo takes 49 days. Buddhists (Book of the dead) say 49 days are the time when soul reenters a body after reincarnation. DMT surprisingly cannot elicit tolerance, this implies a special role in normal human physiology or disorders. DMT is too strong for deep psychological work, it is a potentially personality changing, controlled traumatic experience. DMT is the only known psychedelic that makes people regularly meet up with other entities. The person is aware of them and they are aware of the person. Nobody started psychotherapy to learn more or had any long term positive or negative effect. Does the brain quantum computing? Ego is first and foremost a body ego. There is not real ego without body. Brain releases ketamine and other neuroprotective compounds in a near death state, but why do they have psychedelic properties? Mediating the entering and leaving of the life force? Is endogenous DMT a reality thermostat keeping us in a narrow band of awareness? Dependencies and addictions are significantly lower among psychedelic users. Administer DMT to terminally ill could reduce fear by doing a dry run of death?	Clinical study on a psychedelic substance + drama + science and fiction. I have enjoyed it in every aspect, but might not recommend for everyone.	finished	****
The Inevitable: Understanding the 12 Technological Forces That Will Shape Our Future	Kevin Kelly	1, Becoming: operation and maintenance is needs energy like working against entropy; newbie is the new norm. 2, Cognifying: AI winter, industrial revolution vs AI and robotics revolution, robotics make production cheap, transportation will become the main cost, production will be brought back to rich countries. AI will cause an identity crisis for humanity: who are we? Will AI tell us? Will we redefine ourselves in relation to the AI? Most of your coworkers are gonna be machines. It is not a race against the machines, you will be payed based on how well you can work together with machines. Line between you and robots will blend. 3, Flowing: Internet is a copy machine. Copy is free, data is free, interpretation, manuals, analysis will be expensive. 4 ,Screening: Consuming information is very different now. Much more superficial, but in context, wherever or whenever it is needed, and with active feedback loop. People read and write much-much more then 10-20 years ago. 5, Accessing: Owning is outdated, accessing is everything, every year we own less. Generating a unit of GDP requires every year less kgs of mass. Accessing even our memories from cloud. Peer-to-peer decentralised accessing. 6, Sharing: New digital socialism. Digital government. Shift from hierarchies to decentralisation of everything. Sharing economy. Wikipedia. Flat organisations. Open source. Crowd funding. Collective loans. Peer-to-peer banks. 7, Filtering: We can access to much information, in fact everything. Average can access more than the owners of the largest libraries before. The key is filtering, through AI, recommendations, through active feedbacks. We do not even know how Facebook filters now, that is the value. Human attention worths money, this is measurable. Attention is commoditized. Super abundance. Human experiences the only thing that will not get cheaper, but more expensive. 8, Remixing: Information is version controlled. 9, Interacting: Everything is getting interactive. TV. Less things get non-interactive. Easy to extend our body with interactive machines e.g. car, but now everything. 10, Tracking: Quantified self. Personalisation from healthcare to government. Transparency and privacy issues. Social media`s biggest learning is that personalisation and sharing is more important than privacy. 11, Questioning: Around the end of the 20th century most of the population was only information consumer (TV, etc.). Now we are actively surfing and investigating on the internet. It is a trance like state of associations. 12, Beginning: the first time in history people and things get connected in real time, all time. That is a new stage of existence. Connected to AIs. AIs that are capable of building more intelligent AIs lead to a singularity.	Very interesting technology trend analysis and implications by one of the most interesting technology philosophers alive, who also founded the Wired magazine. Must read for any visionary geek.	finished	****
Siddhartha	Hermann Hesse	What is your expertise? "waiting, fasting, thinking" Superiority of experiencing over theories or intellect	Little Prince style fiction. Different stages of life and understanding of life of a guy living during the time of Buddha.	finished	**

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Thinking fast and slow	Daniel Kahneman	Humans violate rational choices "consistently", there are well known systematic errors. (prospect theory) System 1 is the intuition and we don`t have access to that, System 2 is rational but lazy. Effortful mental activity is expensive in glucose, that is why we are lazy to think, get tired of thinking, and we experience "ego depletion" after effortful exercises, which can reversed with glucose. The ability or the effort needed to control attention and emotion has a strong genetic background too. The laziness of our thinking can me measured. The mind has a graph database, a term activates many associated ideas (priming), but that is unconscious, and you know far less about yourself than you would think. Mood effects our connection with our intuition: unhappy people (danger) loose control with intuition and think more rationally, good mood (environment is safe) makes us lazy to think and become more creative. Abnormality can intuitively kickstart logical thinking. Causal thinking is intuitive, whereas statistical thinking is difficult and logical, thus, we intuitively search for causes even at random events and make statistical errors. E.g. the best schools are the smaller ones just because they are more variable. Smart husbands tend to have less smart wives just because the husband deviates from the norm. Anchoring effect when negotiating. Insensitivity to the strength of the evidence. What you see is all there is, and neglect what you know that you don`t know. Large gap between individual cases and statistical facts. Convergence to the mean: punishment and praise is ineffective but with convergence to the mean it seems that bad performers (or ppl who don`t please us) improve after punishment (or being nasty to them) but good performers (or ppl who please us) just become worse after praise. It is a pervert joke of life. The illusion of validity: even if our predictions prove to be random we believe in them and don`t change (e.g. job interview). Intuitive intensity matching. We can develop useful intuitive skills when the environment is not chaotic (regular, "high validity environments: ") and we had enough opportunities to practise, in all other cases we should not believe in our intuitions. Duration neglect for pleasure, pain, etc, only the peak counts in our memories. The remembering self and the experiencing self are different. We choose vacations, purchases (car) with duration neglect, with the remembering self, the experiencing self is often a stranger. You use the vacation to satisfy your remembering self. Well being is heritable in general, but experienced happiness and life satisfaction are different! Pain, noise (biological signals) and depression (self reinforcing miserable thoughts) are not adaptable, everything else is, e.g. paraplegics, blinds, etc mood on average is not worse than a lottery winners mood. Climate does not matter either (focusing illusion). Miswanting: buy an expensive car vs join a regular social event (focusing illusion + duration neglect) Mental accounting: separate cost/benefit calculation for specific topics	Incredible amount of learnings. However, lengthy and sometimes goes too much into the details or brings too many examples. But altogether an awesome book by a Nobel prize winner on how our thinking diverges from rationality.	finished	*****
Work Rules!: Insights from Inside Google That Will Transform How You Live and Lead	Laszlo Bock	Peter Drucker: "Culture eats strategy for breakfast." Don`t hire fast. Behaving like founders vs employees. Not empowering ppl but the community, collective feedback from every level: bad processes, managers performance, happiness/satisfaction, etc. Wayne Rosen, engineering VP, after the Google IPO: better buy two Lamborghini cos he will destroy one. Make Kudos easier. Teaching each other. Surveys on social perceptions of others, and share only the rank!	Large overlap with the "How Google works" book, but goes much more into the details around culture and people issues. However, it is never enough to learn from Google.	finished	****
Who: The A Method for Hiring	Geoff Smart	Use a scorecard (open position requirements vs. candidate). High performance should not be tolerated at the expense of culture, but, studies show that "cheetah CEOs" (fast moving, focused, aggressive) are more successful than "lamb CEOs" (team player types with top emotional intelligence).	Too much focused on mid and higher level management hiring. Overselling a systematic hiring approach ("top grading") from a consulting company and less about offering unconventional or important principles or ideas.	finished	**
Turn the Ship Around!: A True Story of Turning Followers into Leaders	L. David Marquet	Distributing leadership and responsibility (from leader-follower model to leader-leader model) in a strictly hierarchical organisation, lead to extreme success by all metrics. Many small culture hacks e.g. changing peoples mind to not wait for orders but be very transparent on long term high level goals and their role in it, let them own the problem solving and just let them be transparent on what they intend to do.	Great story, out of the box thinking on leadership. More of a story than a practical guide but many clear principles.	finished	****
Fooled by Randomness: The Hidden Role of Chance in Life and in the Markets	Nassim Nicholas Taleb	Basic probability theory, learning, overfitting, etc. in real life (e.g. successful people are very often just the tail distribution from the large numbers, even with random decisions there would be many successful ones).	Interesting if you did not study this before.	finished	***
Meditations	Marcus Aurelius	Stoicism is more of an operating system for life than a philosophical theoretical system. Too many learnings... Focus on what you can control, face and practise your fears, etc.	Difficult reading, but most important lessons in life and one of the most practical books on philosophy ever.	reading	***
Lean Enterprise: How High Performance Organizations Innovate at Scale	Jez Humble	Serve the organisation or serve the hierarchy? Lean = Visualising value stream, increasing feedback, amplifying learning, empowering teams, reducing waste and delays, limiting work in progress, making small incremental changes, continuously improving. Dissociate funding decisions from the annual budget cycle, and stop worrying if it is capital or operations! 1857, Helmuth von Moltke: "no plan survives the contact with the enemy". Culture where people take responsibility for the consequences: 1, You built it, you run it!, 2, Turn IT into a a product development org. 3, Invest in reducing complexity. Implement mission command.	The most important lean/agile/UX/design/enterprise best practises and books merged in one, not too many new things if you know them. Incredible amount of bullshit, but the "bullshit to gems" ratio is also still very good.	finished	***
Man's Search for Meaning	Viktor Frankl	Positive psychology. 3 stages of hell; loosing, living without humanity and reintegrating with humanity.	Many top lists say it was among the top 10 most important books of all time.	finished	***
2015		Keywords: technology, evolution of organisations			
Reinventing Organizations	Frederic Laloux	Teal organisation concept, the macro implication of the highest level of Maslow`s hierarchy. Self organising vs hierarchical systems, in nature, economy and human organization.	Eye opening but a bit of pseudoscience.	finished	*****
How Google Works	Eric Schmidt	Two pizza rule, kill the HIPPOs, 70/20/10 time allocation, interviewing is the most important skill, etc.	A startup scaled up, the real lean enterprise. Easy to read, very important concepts, but mainly anecdotes.	finished	****
The Innovator's Dilemma: When New Technologies Cause Great Firms to Fail	Clayton M. Christensen	...		reading	
Collective Genius: The Art and Practice of Leading Innovation	Linda A. Hill	Capabilities of innovation: creative abrasion, agility, resolution	Great book from a Harvard Business School Prof on innovation.	finished	****
The Psychedelic Explorer's Guide: Safe, Therapeutic, and Sacred Journeys	James Fadiman	How microdosing psychedelics change cognitive capabilities, alters states of mind, and how they can be used for problem solving.	Stanford professor expaining his controlled experiments on engineering problem solving with the help of psychedelic agents.	finished	****
The Singularity Is Near: When Humans Transcend Biology	Ray Kurzweil	How to think about future, IT, biotech, nanotech in 40 years. Not a very practical reading, but amazingly interesting. Basically the world is gonna end around 2045 how we know it right now, because of the exponential trends in many areas.	Eye opening but a bit of pseudoscience.	finished	*****
The Fourth Paradigm: Data-Intensive Scientific Discovery	Tony Hey	How learning and scientific discovery changes and accelerates with data. Switching from hypothesis driven research to hypothesis free, discovery type of research. How medicine accelerates in pushing discoveries to bedside: 500 year ago it was about 150 years, now it is about 15, in 2045 it is gonna be close to zero. Scientific discovery paradigms: 1. Thousand years ago – Experimental Science, Description of natural phenomena (e.g. Hippocrates) 2. Last few hundred years – Theoretical Science, Newton's Laws, Maxwell's Equations… (e.g. specialized clinicians) 3. Last few decades – Computational Science, Simulation of complex phenomena (e.g. evidence based medicine) 4. Today – Data-Intensive Science, Scientists overwhelmed with data sets from many different sources Data captured by instruments, generated by simulations, by sensor networks…	A couple of distinct articles from great thinkers in many areas.	finished	***
2014					
The Art of the Start: The Time-Tested, Battle-Hardened Guide for Anyone Starting Anything	Guy Kawasaki	Startup basics.	Did not finish, too many known things for me	gave up	***
The Obstacle Is the Way: The Timeless Art of Turning Trials into Triumph	Ryan Holiday	Stoic philosophy, the title tells everything.	For the masses, the american way of stoicism. If you are too lazy to go more into the details that is your book.	finished	**
The Art of Learning: An Inner Journey to Optimal Performance	Josh Waitzkin	Learning techniques with the eyes of a chess prodigy and bjj master.	Interesting journey from the an interesting author, although not too practical.	finished	**

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Influence: The Psychology of Persuasion	Robert B. Cialdini	Top ~10 influencing mechanisms, great.	If you read only one book on influencing techniques this shlould be the one. Very practical and also very professional.	finished	*****
Vagabonding: An Uncommon Guide to the Art of Long-Term World Travel	Rolf Potts	Higher Mashow level of travelling	If you travel a lot you feel this. If not, that is your book.	finished	**
2013					
Flow: The Psychology of Optimal Experience	Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi	Very intuitive concepts, but very important to understand	Lengthy but easy to read.	finished	****
The Lean Startup: How Today's Entrepreneurs Use Continuous Innovation to Create Radically Successful Businesses	Eric Ries	Reach success with tech startup companies, or how to test new ideas rapidly.	Pseudoscience, superficial concepts, unclear ideas, but they are too fundamental to miss.	finished	*****
Business Model Generation: A Handbook for Visionaries, Game Changers, and Challengers	Alexander Osterwalder	How to think visually about business models and how to find new ways systematically.	A cartoon book but very practical.	finished	****
The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy	Douglas Adams	Absurd sci-fi story on "life".	Very readable, very funny.	finished	***
Fundamentals of Clinical Trials	Friedman, L.M		Very detailed and specific.	finished	**
2012					
No: The Only Negotiating System You Need for Work and Home	Jim Camp	Important strategies to negotiate with a clear head.		finished	****
Losing My Virginity: The Autobiography	Richard Branson	Boring chronological book without too many insights about one of the most interesting humans on Earth		gave up	*
The Fine Art of Small Talk: How to Start a Conversation in Any Situation	Debra Fine	Short, nothing extremely new, but covers the topic well		finished	**
The 4-hour body	Timothy Ferriss	Experiment with your body, fitness, nutrition, sex, etc. interesting, a bit too diverse topics.		gave up	***
2010					
Getting Things Done: The Art of Stress-Free Productivity	David Allen	A classic on how to work in an environment with 50+ mails/tasks a day, a system for knowledge workers in the IT era.		finished	*****
Professional Services Marketing	Mike Schultz	Professional services basics, too little new information		gave up	*
The Happiness Hypothesis: Finding Modern Truth in Ancient Wisdom	Jonathan Haidt	Positive psychology ("how to have a happy and fulfilling life") in different religions and cultures.		finished	*****
Peak: How Great Companies Get Their Mojo from Maslow (J-B US non-Franchise Leadership)	Chip Conley	Practical guide on how to deal with customers, employees and stakeholders/owners based on Masholw`s hieararchy of needs		finished	***
Good to Great: Why Some Companies Make the Leap... and Others Don't	Jim Collins	What makes a difference when in comes to success of companies		finished	****
The Innovator's Prescription: A Disruptive Solution for Health Care	Clayton M. Christensen	What is the problem with healthcare today? A bit too dry but amazing "think different" approach.		finished	****
Spiral Dynamics: Mastering Values, Leadership and Change	Don Edward Beck	Interesting, integrated theory of psychology, social psychology, evolutionary psychology, organizational psychology, human sociocultural systems, etc. However, somewhat overcomplicated ideas/reading, less practical, academic sounding but still feels like a bit of pseudoscience. If you have the patience I believe it is a great, I did not have to finish it. Maybe later.		reading	***
Rework	Jason Fried	Extremely successful small tech business founders tell their productivity hacks		finished	***
The 4-Hour Workweek	Timothy Ferriss	Productivity, values in life, how to achieve, how to focus, how to be happy, etc. Superficial book but extremely powerful unconvential ideas, very inspiring.		finished	*****
Tribal Leadership: Leveraging Natural Groups to Build a Thriving Organization	Dave Logan	Levels (Mashlow`s) of organisational culture/mood, how to push the group to a next level, how work with group dynamics, how to inspire and engage people.		finished	****
Delivering Happiness: A Path to Profits, Passion, and Purpose	Tony Hsieh	Unconventional leadership of a CEO who`s company was (later) acquired by Amazon and that is the largest Holacracy organisation in 2015. Focus on purpose, making customers and employees happy and everything follows.		finished	***
2009					
What do you say after you say hello?: The psychology of human destiny	Eric Berne		Sorskonyv in Hungarian. Too long and dry.	gave up	**
Games People Play: The Basic Handbook of Transactional Analysis	Eric Berne		A classic on understanding the games we play in our everyday life`s repeatedly and unconsciously.	finished	*****
Age of Propaganda: The Everyday Use and Abuse of Persuasion	Elliot Aronson		A classic book on psychology of marketing.	finished	*****
1984	George Orwell		Classic.	finished	***
2008 and earlier					
The Metamorphosis	Franz Kafka			finished	**
The Unbearable Lightness of Being	Milan Kundera			finished	***
American Psycho	Bret Easton Ellis			finished	**
Surely You're Joking, Mr. Feynman	Richard Phillips Feynman	Funny stories from a curious genius.	Reading for the beach.	finished	***
The God Delusion	Richard Dawkins	A militant atheist scientist on religion. Was interesting but too dry, too many facts.		gave up	***
The Selfish Gene	Richard Dawkins	A classic book from an evolutionary biologist, and how to think about genetics, society, survival strategies, memes, etc.		finished	*****
Unweaving the Rainbow	Richard Dawkins	Beauty of art with a scientist`s eyes.		finished	*****
The Alchemist	Paulo Coelho	Fairy tail	Little Prince reinvented	finished	**
Fuveskonyv	Sandor Marai				
A Brief History of Time: From the Big Bang to Black Holes	Stephen Hawking		The larger picture of everything.	finished	****
The Social Animal	Elliot Aronson			finished	****
The Lord of the Rings: The Fellowship of the Ring, The Two Towers, The Return of the King	J. R. R. Tolkien			finished	****

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Freedom in Exile: The Autobiography of The Dalai Lama	Dalai Lama			finished	***
Eichmann in My Hands: A Compelling First-Person Account by the Israela Agent Who Captured Hitler's Chief Executioner	Peter Z. Malkin			finished	***